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# Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, October 23, 2025

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WYjexkooyB0
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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**[00:10:39]** okay good morning it's 9 a.m and i will now call this meeting to order as is customary for this board we'll begin our meeting with a moment of silence followed by the pledge of allegiance pledge allegiance to the flag of the united states of america and to the republic for which it stands

**[00:11:18]** one nation under god indivisible with liberty and justice for all this morning i'll note that i've approved the remote participation of ida mcpherson under the board's bylaws and the provisions of the freedom of information act miss mcpherson is participating remotely under 2.2-3708.3 b4 of the code of virginia because she's currently in california visiting with family

**[00:11:49]** um as we move forward is there a motion to approve the agenda as presented so move hold on hold on um pause for a second um okay i'm sorry dr ackerman is there a motion to approve the agenda

**[00:12:20]** as presented so moved second dr ackerman aye mr green aye dr northern aye miss mcpherson did you hear us no we'll skip miss kilgore and chair votes aye all right staff has provided the members of the board with draft minutes before the meeting is there a motion to approve the meeting minutes as presented to the board. So moved. Second. Dr. Ackerman. Aye. Mr. Green. Aye.

**[00:12:54]** Dr. Northern. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay as we have done for past couple of years the board appreciates being able to feature our wonderful arts programs from across the

commonwealth by having students perform at the beginning of our meetings. This morning we have Attlee High School's Dissonance Choir as an award-winning soprano alto ensemble under the direction of Mr. Nathan Berenstian. Is that how you say it? Good, close enough. Participants rage

[00:13:32] from freshmen to seniors. Dissonance Choir has successfully competed for over a decade, winning state-level competitions in both classical and jazz music. Also in attendance to support Atlee High School's choir is Principal John Wheeler and Hanover County Superintendent Dr.

[00:13:50] Lisa Pennycuff. So we would like to welcome you all this morning, and if you all want to come up forward, the board will come down so that we can see you.

[00:13:59] We have two selections for you this morning.

[00:14:50] We will start with Jumita Toile, composed by Claude Debussy, from poetry written by Theodore DeBondo, and I will now read for you the translation. Starry night, under your veils, under your breeze and your perfume, a sad lie of its size, I dream of love lapsed.

[00:15:11] A serene melancholy unfurls in the pit of my heart, and I hear the soul of my beloved trembling in the dreamlike wood. I see again in our fountain, your eyes blue like the skies, this rose, it's your breath, and these stars are your eyes.

[00:15:28] Our second selection is a famous jazz standard, Moonglow, composed by Irving Mills, with poetry written by Eddie Delang.

[00:20:53] - Okay, we are back and we will proceed with recognition.

[00:28:55] So for our recognition this morning, Dr. Northern will do the introduction of our guests. - There we go.

[00:29:11] - Today we are honored to recognize extraordinary world language educators. The following educators, Dr. Mao Fin-Singh, Jennifer Carson, and Lisa Foer, were recently recognized by the Foreign Language Association of Virginia, or FLAVA, for their contributions to teaching and learning in the area of world languages.

[00:29:31] FLAVA serves as an organization of professionals in education and business to promote and enhance student teaching and learning and appreciation of foreign language cultures and literatures. Dr. Lisa Harris, World Languages Coordinator in the Office of Humanities, recently presented the resolutions that we will share with you today at the Foreign Language Association of Virginia Annual Fall Conference Awards Ceremony.

[00:29:56] Dr. Mao-Fing Singh, Professor of Chinese inaugural director of the institute of world languages at the university of virginia was named the foreign language association of virginia as the recipient of the 2025 marshall brannan flava award for excellence in world language teaching and has been named as the 2025 virginia post-secondary world language teacher of the year this award honors one post-secondary world language educator each year who has made outstanding contributions in the profession dr Dr. Singh was selected for this honor due to her extensive leadership in the field.

[00:30:33] She has served in multiple key leadership roles, including founder and president of the Chinese Language Teachers Association of Virginia, consultant for the College Board's AP Chinese program, and mentor for the American Council on the Teaching of Foreign Language. Further, she's recognized as a national leader and has significantly impacted K-12 education due to her leadership in

Virginia's StarTalk Chinese Teacher and Student Academies, which provide immersive professional learning for k-12 students and educators dr singh is unfortunately unable to join us today however she will receive her resolution by our department staff we thank

[00:31:11] her for her service to the field as the 2025 virginia post-secondary world language teacher of the year next miss jennifer carson we come on up jennifer you can come up this way jennifer Carson is a nationally respected leader in world language education. She was named by the Foreign

[00:31:48] Language Association of Virginia as a recipient of the 2025 Helen Warren or Burke Flava Distinguished Service Award. Today we are pleased to recognize Ms. Carson as the 2025 Virginia Distinguished Service Award for World Language Honoree. This award honors one language professional teacher every year who has made outstanding contributions to the profession. Ms. Carson was selected for this honor as her career has been marked by exceptional service to students and educators across the commonwealth. She has advanced world language instruction and policy including serving

[00:32:23] on the world language standards of learning and the Virginia seal of bilateracy committees. Congratulations Ms. Carson on your recognition as the 2025 Distinguished Service Award for world language recipient and now I will read part of the resolution. There are three six maybe six bullet points I'm going to read I'm going to read the highlights Virginia Board of Education resolution of recognition presented to Jennifer Carson 2025 Distinguished Service Award recipient whereas Jennifer Carson a nationally respected leader in world language education was named by

[00:33:00] the foreign language association of Virginia as the recipient of the 2025 Helen Warner Burke Flava Distinguished Service Award and whereas this award honors one world language professional each year who has made outstanding contributions to the profession now therefore be it resolved that the members of the board of education express to jennifer carson their sincere congratulations upon her recognition of as virginia's 2025 helen warner burke flava distinguished service award recipient and extend their heartfelt appreciation for her devoted service

[00:33:36] and exceptional leadership thank you all right next up we have lisa four miss lisa four serves as a spanish teacher at abington high school in washington county virginia she was named by the foreign language association of virginia as the recipient of the 2025 david cox flava excellence

[00:34:13] in teaching k-12 award today we recognize miss four as the 2025 virginia k-12 world language Teacher of the Year. This award honors one teacher annually for excellence in world language education, recognizing outstanding instructional practice, leadership, and student impact. Ms. Foer was selected for this honor as she has truly transformed language learning in a rural community by creating an immersive classroom environment grounded in global citizenship and linguistic proficiency. Her students have achieved exceptional outcomes including earning both the Virginia and and Global Seals of Biliteracy,

[00:34:52] attaining top scores on nationally recognized language proficiency assessments, and receiving advanced placement in college credit for their language skills. Congratulations, Ms. Foer, on your recognition as the 2025 Virginia K-12 World Language Teacher of the Year.

[00:35:09] And I will read the resolution. The Virginia Board of Education Resolution of Recognition presented to Lisa Foer, 25 Virginia K-12 World Language Teacher of the Year. Whereas Lisa Foer, Spanish teacher at Abington High School in Washington County, Virginia, was named by the Foreign Language Association of Virginia as a recipient of the 2025 David Cox Flava Excellence in Teaching Award, and

whereas this award honors one teacher for excellence in world language education, recognizing outstanding

[00:35:43] instructional practice, leadership, and student impact, now therefore be it resolved that the members of the Board of Education expressed to Lisa Foer their sincere congratulations upon her recognition as Virginia's 2025 World Language Teacher of the Year and extend their heartfelt appreciation for her devoted service and exceptional accomplishments. Thank you guys.

[00:36:21] That concludes our recognition. That concludes our presentation. Thank you. Okay. I think the superintendent is going to go and take pictures with our recognized award winners today that are present and we will proceed thank you all so very much for being with us today and congratulations as stated in the board's bylaws it's the pleasure of the board to accept public comment on all matters related to public education in Virginia but before we begin today I'd like to share a few comments in the

[00:36:55] manner in which public comment will be conducted oh you got it okay good I ask that you model professionalism dignity and respect for others as you share your thoughts when you begin please provide your name your role or affiliation where you live in Virginia all remarks must be directed to the chair and not to any other individual speakers will have three minutes to share their remarks you'll notice that there is a timer over here on the computer screen as it begins it is green with three minutes at one minute the screen will turn yellow and the screen will turn red when your time is up at that point please close

[00:37:34] your remarks promptly if you have any paper copies of anything that you would like to provide to the board mr. Joe Crook who is raising his hand right now is the board's regulatory and board coordinator and Joe will take those written comments and provide them to the board as soon as possible you may also email a copy of your remarks or anything that you would like to have the board to provided with at b o e at d o e dot virginia.gov and with that we will begin with scott braebrand

[00:38:10] followed by kennedy stringfield president creasy superintendent gullickson and members of the virginia board of education my name is scott braebrand i'm executive director for vass i live in lynchburg virginia on behalf of virginia school division superintendents we respectfully submit the following feedback around the sol proficiency implementation plan we strongly support a designation of the 25-26 school year as a planning year with no proficiency changes while the videoe and school divisions develop meaningful stakeholder communication provide

[00:38:48] essential professional learning and identify essential funding streams and resources we strongly support your four to five year phase-in approach to ensure intentional transition planning and allow for further modeling of metrics by VDOE in divisions.

[00:39:04] We respectfully urge the Board to extend the existing proficiency in graduation requirements for all students, not just seniors who are already enrolled in high school. According to state code 8VAC20-132-51, requirements for graduation cannot be changed during a student cohort's four years.

[00:39:25] The requirements in place when students enter 9th grade must be honored through graduation. This should include changes to cut scores that directly impact students' ability to pass the required EOC assessments for graduation. We also want to continue to work with you around concerns regarding advanced math pathways, the new growth metric that will replace VVOS, expedited retesting and alternative credits, double jeopardy due to federal identification, and performance category rounding.

[00:39:55] Finally, we want to partner with you more deeply around your communications and supports as we move the SOL Proficiency Plan forward. Schools need division-ready communication tools, including infographic, parent letters, talking points, and training modules to help teachers and school boards and students and families understand the new scale and its implications with the focus on raising expectations through a phased approach.

[00:40:20] Consistent statewide communication will build trust and understanding during this transition. We ask that these communication plans be available for stakeholder review by your December 11th board meeting. The new cut scores will also require extensive student interventions and sufficient staff to design and deliver individualized plans to students.

[00:40:41] Without substantial state investment to fund and provide qualified intervention for personnel and resources, successful implementation will be impacted. As always, we look forward to continued partnership with you on this important work for the Commonwealth.

[00:40:56] Thank you very much and have a nice day. Kennedy Stringfield, followed by Jim Cowan. Okay, Kennedy Stringfield's not here. Jim Cowan, okay.

[00:41:16] Kathy Halverson, followed by Alexander Halverson.

[00:41:37] Thank you, thank you. Hello, welcome to the Library of Virginia.

[00:42:02] I'm Alex Halverson. Today, we have something to tell you. Powerton helped me for three and a half years. Powerton kept me in a dead closet. they will stay in there now there was a light mommy saved me and then i got a little bit scared mommy takes me home but mommy cannot find me that way he will find me so power 10 didn't pay And the code is 20-81-150.

[00:42:42] Well, we have another thing for you. Ephesians 4.3 Get rid of all hard feelings, anger, and rage. Stop all fighting and lying. Put away every form of hatred. Forgive another justice God forgave him as of what Christ has done.

[00:43:04] Now here's another one. Father, if you are possessing, take this cup of suffering away from me, but do what you want. Not what I want. Now, here's a free poem that I want to write. I was ten, and all I wanted was to learn.

[00:43:22] School was my favorite place until that day. They grabbed me, said nothing, and shoved me in the closet. It was dark. It was cold. I was alone. I didn't even know what I did wrong. My mom came, but they couldn't find me, because I was just a kid, hidden in the dark.

[00:43:44] Now I'm still sleeping right on, because darkness still feels like fear. Now everyone did pay for it, and then we're teaching better. Now they're helping us to enjoy themselves. There must be something wrong with Palatine.

[00:44:03] They didn't pay. They didn't go good. We have a better thing to learn about. Thank you so much for the poem. Thank you. Thank you. Hello, Kathy Halverson from Powhatan.

[00:44:34] I don't know what else to say after that. Three and a half years has been torture. We went to federal court. Federal court judge said to send them to private placement. They didn't abide. They were threatening another chins on my husband and I.

[00:44:53] They filed the chins back in 2022. out of retaliation had to hire an attorney we fought and fought and fought and i was not willing for them to try to take my child we waited a very long time for this child and he's a blessing so we started looking around and found liberty university online and the teachers have been amazing he's been able to get his voice he's able to interact where he wasn't able to do that in powhatan because they just threw him restrained him until he started turning blue what type of

[00:45:33] education system is this i've asked for accountability justice nothing is being done nothing the principal nothing all these teachers they still have their licenses you heard him straight from the mouths of babes how is this happening in our school systems three and a half years they received federal funding to educate him he received zero zero they're supposed to document restraint seclusion december one count nothing's being documented you know why because it would be

[00:46:10] considered an unsafe location he was constantly being thrown into a dark room to where he's scared he has to sleep with the lights on because he's scared of the dark we go on vacation we have to have a light is that fair to him this isn't the only child they restrain it's on the first grade hallway on the right hand side they do that i saw the principal dragging another child into that

[00:46:42] room by their self what are we doing with special education nothing until we get rid of samantha hollands nothing's going to be done and y'all start taking accountability and getting rid of these people that are causing harm this child has ptsd they allowed him to hit his head on the cinder block wall 48 times 48 times why to get data as a parent would you let your child hit

[00:47:16] their head on a cinder block wall without intervention zero he had zero behavior intervention plan he had nothing nothing if his behavior was so bad why wasn't there something done we spent thousands probably two hundred thousand in legal fees only for me to have to educate him with liberty right now while they received the money thank you thank you so much dan zacharias followed

[00:47:54] by wendy little thank you madam president and members of the board i'm dan zacharias director of the old dominion association of church schools live in the beautiful shenandoah valley where right now it's autumn my favorite season of the year and uh the comments i'm going to share i've shared before, but I thought it'd be good to share them again because we have some new board members

[00:48:28] who haven't had the opportunity to hear me say these things. And I want to propose to you a hypothetical, an imaginary policy, which I hope will sound absurd to you when I say it. Imagine that in private kindergarten through 12th grade schools in Virginia, and even religious kindergarten through 12 schools. The Department of Ed were directly subsidizing those schools, in some cases to the

[00:49:01] tune of tens of thousands of dollars annually, in exchange for requiring that they align their curricula with the standards of learning, and also sending licensing inspectors into the K-12 schools to aggressively inspect those schools and sometimes overreach their authority under the pretext of child safety, K private and religious K to 12. Hopefully that sounds nonsensical to you.

[00:49:38] I believe that in both private and public sectors, such an idea is contrary to rational thought. However, if you just substitute pre-K for K to 12, suddenly it makes sense to a lot of people, and that's exactly what is happening. Bad actors are being subsidized by the Department of Ed, and those with religious exemptions that are safe are being aggressively inspected so we have a dilemma in our schools very often where we have the k-5 and the k-4 class side by side and the

[00:50:16] licensing inspector has purview over the over the younger class but not over the older class we had a recent example where an inspector openly bemoaned the fact that she and actually insisted on inspecting the entire school pre-k to 12 and threatened to call the police.

[00:50:38] Fortunately, the administrator stood his ground and that overreach did not occur in that instance. But what does it portend? And none of this is making a single child safer. And the question is, how long can these contradictory models of policy between private pre-k and k-12 coexist under this department and this commonwealth?

[00:51:01] very concerned about it and we appreciate uh your time and listening to our concerns have a good day

[00:51:09] wendy little followed by yanice jackson greetings board of virginia my name is wendy little and my

[00:51:48] son is aaron little did ms glickson falsify to the public that there's nothing wrong with your grants because i beg to differ with you um i won a state complaint in 2023 about chesterfield county public schools refusing to educate my child and couldn't figure out how to get him out of a private day school just into the public home zone school i won the appeal this was 2023 for the prior year chesterfield did not comply samantha hollins did not out of her department nor patricia haimes nobody enforced it you have to enforce that by law that's your job you enforce corrective

[00:52:27] actions that you issue yourself those are federal orders of education for compensatory education it was never done so instead the school division sued me with an unlicensed un not unlicensed but un no an unprocured law firm and it's been sitting there for two years so all kinds of other stuff in between happened but nothing for aaron and this is his senior year i mind you he is to wear a graduation cap this spring he has been left without an appropriate eighth grade education Still, this is three and a half years we're talking about.

[00:53:07] When people come up here and they testify and they give you receipts, you figure it out and you find out what's wrong. So after the last time I was here, Senator Favola said, holy cow, this kid's been out of school for three years. Yeah, they're citing, they're claiming it's in litigation.

[00:53:23] We can't do anything. That is pendency. You were there at Commission on Youth on July 7th when I argued and screamed that at the top of my lungs. You cannot excuse state complaint, due process, or any educational litigation to keep him without school.

[00:53:39] And then y'all are hemorrhaging a quarter of a million dollars out of the OAG's office to continue to keep him out. It's called pendency. You cannot keep a child without public school forever. Also, you are in violation, and this has been stated before.

[00:53:56] When the school division doesn't educate the child, the VDOE and VBOE must. Did y'all know I filed due process on y'all twice and the VDOE once? Probably not. I got a determination that's going to put your statement from yesterday and your response to Favola, oh, it's in litigation.

[00:54:13] All these places have been supporting the family. False. Completely false. If you're going to still excuse litigation, you just admitted your grants are fraudulent. Y'all have admitted it many times. So stop with the bullshit. Samantha Hollins is hiding information.

[00:54:29] She withheld Favola's letter. And you're also in violation of 34 CFR 300-600. You must ensure compliance is corrected in no later than one year. No excuses. 34 CFR 300.149, Responsibility for General Supervision.

[00:54:46] 34 CFR 300.227, Direct Services. Thank you. They've been read before. Thank you very much. Erin will graduate, and somebody's going to be accountable, and you're going to respond to my phone calls. Thank you. Yanise Jackson, followed by Lawanda Travis.

[00:55:07] Good morning, Madam Chair and members of the board. My name is Yanise Walker-Jackson, And I stand before you today, not just as a mother, but as an advocate and civil rights defender fighting systematic injustice in the Virginia special education system.

[00:55:23] Since December 2023, I have filed and documented over 30 IDEA due process complaints, 10 notices of intent to sue, multiple insurance and misconduct claims, altogether exceeding roughly over $27 million in documented damages.

[00:55:43] Each filing exposes one truth. Families are being retaliated against, silenced, and denied their legal rights under IDEA and FAPE, okay? My son, a bright ninth grader scholar, was illegally unenrolled from North Star Academy on September the 9th.

[00:56:01] Since that day, he has received no education, no services, and no lawful notice, a direct violation of IDEA Part B and Virginia accreditation standards. Therefore, I address you directly, Ms. Creasy.

[00:56:17] As Executive Director and Head of Virginia Public, I'm sorry, and Head of Virginia Private Schools, I urge you to immediately suspend or revoke North Stars Academy's accreditations and license until they are back in full compliance with federal and state law, and until my son is properly re-enrolled in his private day placement at the expense of Colonial Heights Public Schools as required by IDEA.

[00:56:43] This is not personal. is lawful accountability. Every complaint, every document, every claim I've submitted forms a clear record that the system is on notice. Parents like me will not be silenced. I call on the Virginia Department of Education to enforce compliance, restore advocacy rights, and protect every child

[00:57:05] from retaliation and neglect. And to that I say you have been served. Thank you. Good morning, President Creasy and VDOE board members. I will say I'm a little dismayed this morning because what just came before me was something near to my heart. And I'll put this out there. For God so loved the world that he gave his only begotten son, that whosoever believe in him should not

[00:57:45] perish but have everlasting life. As an educator, as a parent, as a community member, and just as a citizen. If you take the oath of being a teacher or anybody serving in the public realm, your love is to keep your child, yourself, and everybody safe. That is our duty as teachers and public servants, and especially as children of God. Again, like I said, I will be here every month talking about my school system that I graduated from because there's no transparency. Children's

[00:58:23] Rights are being violated as well as parents, and safety has gone out the door. We had a meeting last night that was videotaped on YouTube, but my constituents, which is my community, cannot see it. I want to say that between the VDOE, the VSBA, and the organizations that are school-related, you all put out good examples of what a board meeting should look like.

[00:58:53] But do our localities and schools follow it? No. The community is being left in the dark with a lot of things that pertain to the education of their children. And we are afforded a free or paid for education that is good for everybody.

[00:59:18] I got told last night at public comment that when we asked questions that I wouldn't get a question unless I emailed them the question and they emailed me directly. But it's in a public forum. are questions that the public are getting together and trying to get answers to and then I was told it's my responsibility to put it out to the public at some point we have to hold these school boards accountable and we are looking for your help with that and as a military member I do have to ask this question if there is an exit interview for teachers which I thought

[00:59:54] it was or any staff is that in the rules where they have to continue that so we can better our school systems and get qualified teachers thank you Elizabeth Schultz followed by Rodney Jordan good morning I'm here I've had many roles in which I could stand to this microphone an elected official to the 10th largest

[01:00:34] school board in the nation in Fairfax County for eight years I'm a former US Department of Education official I'm the prior assistant state superintendent for the Virginia Department of Education, but I come here today wearing the most important role and label that I can, which is as a mother.

[01:00:57] A mother of four sons who have been through or are currently in the Virginia public school system. And as a parent, God has directed me and my husband as the primary educators of our children.

[01:01:15] So I come to speak to you about these proficiency cut scores. I know for posterity's sake, sometimes we talk about stuff in jargon in a way that the public doesn't necessarily get. So I'm just going to say that the current cut scores reflect proficiency expectations, and we have really outdated ones for the 2016 mathematics and 2017 English standards.

[01:01:42] The cut scores define the minimum score a student must achieve to reach a performance level on a test. And currently, that student performance is a zero to 600 with proficiency, that label proficiency at 400. More often than we want to admit, the focus in schools is to get students to clear that bar and achieve a proficient score on their SOL.

[01:02:06] Very simply, the lower the cut score, the easier it is for a student to clear it and to clear it the first time, to be deemed to be meeting that moniker proficient. Yet, how often do parents find their students who achieve that label later lacking or struggling in their successive years to maintain or demonstrate proficiency in essential knowledge and skills to provide parents and teachers with greater understanding on how a student is tracking and to assist in raising expectations for their student, higher cut scores provide a more accurate picture of where students are, they help the parents

[01:02:45] and the teachers better target support, and it allows for authentically celebrating a student's progress. Raising the proficiency cut scores allows the student to acquire the skills and knowledge they need to be competitive, successful, and to individually thrive after graduation, whether they're headed to a four-year institution, a two-year post-secondary education, into the trades, or directly into the workforce.

[01:03:14] The need to acquire critical thinking problem-solving skills so that they may be fulfilled in the real world is essential in the k-12 experience thank you changes the meaning of proficiency from be raising cuts thank you and just the meaning of proficiency thank you okay thank you please thank you

raise the expectations for yourselves raise these cut scores our students desperately need it Rodney Jordan followed by Candace Lucas. Good morning President Creasy, members of the Virginia

[01:03:53] Board of Education, Superintendent Guggson. My name is Rodney Jordan. I'm here representing Virginia School Boards Association. I live in Norfolk. The recommendations from Superintendent Booker Dwyer and her team regarding proficiency implementation, namely treating school year 25-26 as a zero year, continuing communication with division administrators, leaders, and staff, in implementing a clear and effective public communication plan in collaboration with local school divisions aligns with the feedback received during the VSBA listening session coordinated with the VDOE team.

[01:04:28] As shared previously, VSBA member school boards share with you the goal of setting high expectations for students while providing the supports and resources to undergird every learner to meet those expectations. Local school boards, in representing the vision and values of their communities, collaborate with their division superintendents to set meaningful student achievement goals, informed by data, and driven by quality instruction.

[01:04:56] Our member school boards take the responsibility of local control seriously and the accountability that comes with it. Our members understand the critical importance of flexibility, full funding of public education needs, and effective partnerships in pursuit of continuous improvement, growth, and what Virginia students know and are able to do. Speaking to effective collaborative partnerships we want to thank Dr. Burgwire for her willingness to engage with VSBA Superintendent Goggerson. We thank you for your continually making yourself

[01:05:32] available to inform us and to include VSBA voice in your strategic efforts. And President Creasy, VSBA task forces look forward to your return visit as our special guests and the same invitation extends and exists for each member of board in conclusion please allow me to restate that vsba places excellence in public education with a focus on student achievement at the center of our work our goals include leadership advocacy and support and we appreciate your leadership and look forward to the collaboration

[01:06:09] ahead candace lucas followed by bikura shabazz can you turn the camera timer toward me so i can see you thank you good morning board members my name is dr candace lucas i'm a licensed educator, as well as a licensed special education administrator, also an IDEA enforcer, and we're addressing the fact that the Board of Education and the Virginia Department of Education are basically dead-be parents.

[01:06:44] And when I state that, I mean that you have a legal, ethical, and ministerial responsibility to ensure that IDEA, which is a civil rights law, IDEA, which is a civil rights law, IDEA, is a civil rights law, IDEA, which is a civil rights law, is enforced. It is not optional.

[01:07:04] The Virginia Department of Education has completed its IDEA Part B flow-through application with the U.S. Department of Education, where you stated that you would enforce the IDEA, and you took the money, the grant money, and you haven't enforced it. That might be why Ken Dickey left the country, since he was over that, you know, he's the one who signed document he left the country and went to italy where you can't be deported but my issue is that you sit here every month and hear children being trafficked out of the public school system

[01:07:41] regarding special education i just handed you a document in which hearing officers are being bribed paid bribes by fairfax county public schools and samantha hollands and pat haynes are signing off

on it they call them incentives idea part b money i gave you the account number that's from a foyer request we're we're in a cartel and i dare not mention our little boy carter gunn who was trafficked to rivermont dr ackerman he was trafficked to that school

[01:08:16] by one his aunt who works for you who's under investigation for embezzling ssi funds from him So this level of special education trafficking of our students goes to the highest levels. And it's for money.

[01:08:31] It's all for money. If the BDOE and the Board of Education did what your oath said you were supposed to do, we wouldn't have to file due process complaints, OK? We wouldn't have to go to court. You're not doing your job to protect children.

[01:08:47] And Emily, I told you, you can speak out about Charlie Kirk. I need you to speak out about Carter Gunn. I need you to speak out about Coy Gunn. I need you to speak out about Aaron Little. I need you to speak out about Zarek Jackson.

[01:09:03] Those are real children who need advocates, and this board has a ministerial duty. And if you do not, you will be held accountable personally. No immunity, none. The hearing officers must be removed per the Merced report as of July 7, 2025.

[01:09:23] Remove them, remove them. Thank you. Thank you. Bakura Shabazz, followed by Mike Kalan. Mike Kalan, you can come up to the microphone, please.

[01:09:40] Followed by Cheryl Brinkley. Good morning, Madam President, members of the board and superintendent. My name is Mike Kalan, and I serve as a member of the school board in the city of Virginia Beach.

[01:09:56] I want to note at the outset that I am speaking today solely as a board member individually and not as a representative of my full board. I appreciate the Virginia Board of Education's thoughtful review of the standards of learning proficiency cut scores.

[01:10:14] From my perspective, raising these benchmarks is a positive and appropriate step toward ensuring that the proficient level truly represents a student's readiness for college, career, and civic life.

[01:10:29] Higher expectations send an important message that we believe every Virginia student is capable of achieving at a high level when given the right opportunities and support. In Virginia Beach, we serve approximately 65,000 students across 86 schools.

[01:10:50] We are proud of our division's consistent academic success, but we also recognize that excellence is not a fixed point. It's a continual process of both reflection and growth. Setting higher proficiency standards allows with our long-standing commitment to continuous improvement and it strengthens the credibility of our assessment system statewide. At the same time, I urge that these changes be implemented with care and consideration in mind. Raising proficiency cut scores will have real instructional and operational implications at the division level.

[01:11:29] It'll be essential for the Virginia Department of Education to provide divisions with the necessary supports, including professional development, access to high-quality instructional materials, and timely data tools so that teachers can effectively adjust instruction and students can meet these higher expectations. Communication will also be vital. Families and community members need clear, consistent messaging that higher cut scores do not indicate a decline in

[01:12:02] student performance, but rather a recalibration of what proficiency means in today's academic environment. That understanding will help maintain public trust and reinforce the shared goal of preparing every student for long-term success. I want to commend the board for approaching this issue with diligence, thoughtfulness, and transparency. If we move forward prudently with strong collaboration between the department, local divisions, and our educators, I believe these higher standards can both

[01:12:38] raise expectations and improve outcomes for all of our students across the Commonwealth. As an aside, all that I have seen and read about this process reassures me that these concerns have been and are being addressed I like to thank you for your time you so much continued leadership in advancing educational excellence thank you Cheryl Brinkley okay I'll go back to the ones

[01:13:11] who are at the top of the list Kennedy Stringfield Jim Cowan Bakura Shabazz okay anyone else who would like to speak during public comment please come to the microphone good morning chairman Creasy superintendent Gillickson and members of the board. My name is Krista Arnold and I'm the Executive Director of the Virginia Association of Elementary School Principals. I appreciate the opportunity to speak with you today regarding the proposed implementation of

[01:13:49] RAISE proficiency scores for our students. First I'd like to extend my thanks to Tierra Booker Dwyer for reaching out to the VA ESP to organize a feedback session on this important topic. On October 8th and 9th VA ESP hosted sessions with more than 200 participants given the short notice that the level of participation speaks volumes about the deep interest and concern surrounding this issue i'd like to share a brief summary of the feedback provided during those sessions at the time most principals had not yet

[01:14:29] received their growth scores which left many feeling frustrated about being instructional leaders without having all the data needed to make informed decisions in addition principals expressed that the performance and support framework implemented this past year still needs refinement and clarity they are concerned that a quarter of the way through the school year and without the full results from last spring's assessments the proficiency targets appear to be a moving goal post there were also significant concerns about the expanding number of tier 3

[01:15:06] students who will require intensive support under the new scoring standards. Many principals are already struggling to find qualified teachers and tutors to meet the current level of student need. Furthermore, the Virginia Literacy Act requires a reading plan for every student who does not pass the third or fourth grade SOL. Principals noted that the time spent writing and managing those plans takes away from the time that could be spent directly supporting students in improving their reading skills. The number of plans needed will

[01:15:44] greatly increase based on the new proficiency scores. Principals were also concerned among the 200 member expert committee responsible for these decisions that not one principal was included. The absence of a school-based leadership voice in such critical decisions and discussions is concerning. Finally, The principals highlighted that the NAEP is only about 80% aligned with SOLs, raising questions about the fairness of directly tying proficiency standards to that measure.

[01:16:19] They also noted that last year's fifth graders whose scores qualified them for advanced math would now be considered failing under the proposed new benchmarks. Virginia principals care deeply about our students and their success. Thank you.

[01:16:35] high standards and share your commitment to continuous improvement however we do believe in the importance of intentional well-thought-out plan please thank you this feedback slightly different than my submitted comments but good morning Superintendent Gullick and Gullick Senate members of the board my name is Todd Truitt and I'm the parent of two public school students in Arlington I'm here to speak in strong opposition to pausing any cut score raises this school year per the US Department of Education we have the lowest cut scores in the country the

[01:17:10] plan to raise the cut scores was first announced in a widely publicized report in may 2022 since then you've had a very public process for almost three and a half years the board voted in march 2025 to formalize the last steps of that process and the standard setting committees met over this summer the state superintendent presented on the cut score process at the superintendent's lobbying organization spring convention in april presumably other lobbying organizations were aware. And with a small rise this school year as set forth in the phase-in models, the cut scores would likely only increase to the level they were at in 2013, still some of

[01:17:50] the lowest cut scores in the country. Further, the precedent is that these cut score changes are made mid-school year. The math cut scores were lowered in March 2019, two months before tests were administered. The reading cut scores were going to be approved in March 2020 with the same short testing buffer. Then COVID occurred, delaying that process to the approval in the middle of another school year. Notably, the field's powerful lobbyists were nowhere to be found in public comment in the minutes of those three board meetings in 2019 and 2020. Is the principle of the

[01:18:24] field's lobbyists that cut scores can be immediately lowered in the middle to even late school year, but not slightly raised from the lowest level in the nation in the first semester of a school year with six months of an advance notice. Quite frankly, it appears that many of the lobbyists preferred timing for any cut score raises, never. I asked the field's powerful lobbyists here today to ask your members, why are so many principals and teachers and families just finding out that cut scores will be increased? Why are so many divisions not telling principals, teachers, and families that we have the lowest cut scores in the country? Most importantly,

[01:19:04] whose interests are being served by divisions omitting this material information the public school system's purpose in the virginia constitution is to provide a high quality education to children it's not to employ adults or to cater to the feelings of their powerful lobbyists virginia parents and students should not pay the price for divisions who make a conscious choice to drag their feet and misinform teachers and families enough is enough start the cut score races this year virginia parents and students deserve better thank you okay is there anybody

[01:19:41] else who would like to speak during public comment okay if not the board will proceed and i'll close the public comment period um and so we will proceed with items a through c on the consent agenda is there a motion to waive first review and approve the items on the consent agenda so moved second dr ackerman aye mr green dr northern hi miss kilgore mr monk hi and chair

[01:20:16] votes aye all right moving to item d um i would like to entertain a motion to move that particular item to the november agenda madam president uh move to amend the agenda by removing it item d to the november meeting second is there any discussion on this december meeting excuse me november november yes yeah november doctor northern yeah just to clarify this is to continue talking to principals over the next few weeks and that's correct make sure that they understand

[01:20:51] that's correct so um although maybe miss arnold hadn't heard from all of the principals in her association we have talked to many of them the department has in several of our listening sessions that have been conducted over the last few weeks since the last board meeting but we feel it necessary to ensure that we have the most depth and breadth of voices participating in this conversation and therefore as mentioned yesterday during our work session we will be continuing to keep the portal for public comment open through november 6th at noon the public

[01:21:29] comment portal will remain open through november 6th at noon and we will continue to do listening sessions and so with that being said we would like to ensure that we've collected as many voices as possible on this and move this to the november 13th agenda i would just like to remind everyone that we come back in just about two and a half short weeks so um thank you uh-huh any other questions on this item or this motion excuse me dr ackerman aye mr green aye dr northern aye

[01:22:06] Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Mr. Monk? Aye. And chair votes aye. Thank you. Okay. Item E, Mr. Gilstrap. Good morning, President Greasy, Superintendent Gullickson, and members of the board.

[01:22:29] I'm coming back to you from our September 1st review. Today will be our final review for the advisory board's recommendation for new endorsements. We do have 25 new endorsements that are on the docket for this year.

[01:22:46] I've already presented those to you last month, but I'm open for any questions you might have about this. But we do ask that you approve those today. Are there any questions on this item before I ask my question? Mr. Gilstrap, would you provide us a little bit of information about sort of some more alternative options that we have to what we would consider the traditional routes to many of our licensing programs?

[01:23:13] what are the options that are out there that are different than having to go physically sit in a classroom okay so our alternate route programs which is what we would be referring to include I teach which we've discussed here before the board I teach takes a person that already has a bachelor's degree not necessarily in the subject area that they are wanting to teach but has also passed the praxis exams for that subject area and then it applies instruction through asynchronous learning for the professional practices the teacher

[01:23:50] skills and then with that program there's also internship time where you work with a mentor teacher in a school division and you're allowed to work under a provisional we call it a provisional I teach license because it's slightly different than our other provisional license and then once you've completed that experience you're eligible for a full license. Another program we have is the career switcher program. Career switchers in some ways are similar to iTeach in the sense that you already have a degree, you've already worked in a field that's outside of education, and you go back and take professional practices courses through a university and you work as an intern

[01:24:29] within a school division for a year under a career switcher license. additionally there would also be teachers for america teachers for america is a independent program outside of our state it's a nationally recognized program in which your experiences as a classroom teacher in a school substitute for some of your coursework that you would have taken as a teacher in teacher preparation programs those are our three primary areas that we do that but an alternate route is simply anything outside of the norm and so we do also

[01:25:05] have universities that provide opportunities for teachers to take just the courses that they need to complete their licensure requirements they may have a degree and not go through a formalized alternate program and just take coursework to fill in those gaps and work within a school division for their one year of experience but none of these new endorsement programs are alternative no these are all just subject area endorsements at the university level through our education preparation programs okay are they there

[01:25:38] any other questions for mr. Gil strap here mr. monk we've talked about high quality teacher prep programs being one of the focuses of how we can move the ball understanding of you know I know the application process but any indication of the rigor of some of these programs to ensure that the quality of teacher prep is there and continues?

[01:26:07] Can you speak to that a little? Absolutely. The item you have before you right now is a process where the university has to submit their syllabus, how it aligns with our standards, their student teaching activities that they would have to do within these areas.

[01:26:26] And so we do evaluate that. But later today, you'll have a report from us that is the evaluation of all the programs not just the new ones and we do that annually we also receive a lot of feedback from the universities where they do surveys from employers from the actual people who graduate and from the university to provide information on the quality that the students are shown once they get out into the field we also get data on how they do on their practice tests compared to people that don't go through a university process so those would be the examples that we have on the rigor, whether or not the programs that we currently have, and that's an annual report. That information, which

[01:27:06] you'll receive later today, goes into a Build-A-Table for the Department of Education and that within that Build-A-Table you can compare across universities and across years to see if there's an increase of enrollment, increase of graduation, increase of employment, how the employers are feeling about different graduates from different programs so we get we get the information that way primarily are there any other questions for mr.

[01:27:35] gilstra okay hearing none is there a motion to approve the advisory board on teacher education and licensure's recommendation to approve the new education endorsement programs so moved second is there any are there any questions on this or are there any comments on the motion dr. Ackerman I Aye.

[01:27:58] Mr. Green. Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Mr. Monk. Aye. And Chair Vitz, aye. Thank you, Mr. Gilstrap. Dr. Wallace, we have first review of VLA Intervention Instruction Program Guides.

[01:28:24] Good morning, President Creasy, Superintendent Gullickson, and members of the Board of Education.

[01:28:43] Today I have with me Ann Eaton. She is the lead reviewer with our esteemed partners at UVA and the Virginia Literacy Partnerships. Ann and her team of educators spend countless hours reviewing submitted curriculum documents for recommendations for approval to the board.

[01:29:01] I bring to you this morning the first review of additional supplemental and intervention materials to support the implementation of the Virginia Literacy Act as embodied by the standards of quality. To support school divisions in meeting this requirement, the VLA requires that the Department of Education develop a list of core literacy curricula for students in K through grade five, and supplemental and instructional practices, programs, and interventions for students in kindergarten through grade eight.

[01:29:30] Intervention programs provide systematic, explicit evidence-based instruction for students who persistently struggle to master literacy skills, including phonics and word knowledge, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension. Supplemental programs for grades K through eight provide additional practice and/or instruction to supplement the division's adopted core program.

[01:29:53] VLA requires all divisions to use core instructional K-5 materials, supplemental materials in K-8, and intervention programs in K-8 that are aligned with science-based reading research as set out in their division's literacy plan.

[01:30:10] Previously, the board has approved core literacy curriculum in July and December of 2023 and instructional and supplemental program guides in April of 24, September of 24, and March of 25. These programs were evaluated on the components for which they applied, as well as criteria for the instructional design and usability.

[01:30:32] The review includes a crosswalk of content aligned to the English standards of learning. You'll find in your attachments one through four, the guides that are being recommended for approval. In the boilerplate on page three, you will see a snip of what the divisions are provided with regarding the alignment to the program components.

[01:30:52] And so, for example, the first example you see is an intervention example, and the program provider, name of the program, and recommended use are outlined for the divisions. And then you'll see a graphic that describes where the program met the expectations, highlighted there by that blue dark circle.

[01:31:13] The supplemental program example is on page four and demonstrates a program that meets some criteria, but not all criteria. In this division, a division who selects to adopt a program such as this will only be able to use the program for that specific criteria for which it met.

[01:31:30] It is still a recommendation as it meets the criteria and may provide supplemental services for a gap that that division needs to meet based on their program in the core. So for this program you can see on that page four that writing is where it would be approved for use in the school division and that program would only be approved for writing use, not other uses and so I have with me and Eaton if you have any questions but we are recommending that you review receive this for first review based on the

[01:32:06] superintendent's recommendation are there any questions for Dr. Wallace or Miss Eaton Dr. Northern just a couple quick things first of all I was pretty excited to see Chesapeake Public Schools us you know submit their own I guess curriculum for morphology. I noticed that it said it's accessible only via Google Drive. So I just want to make sure that other divisions had access to it. And I just wanted to hear a little bit of the story behind this, because I don't believe we've seen yet a division submit, and that was

[01:32:44] kind of exciting to me. Yes, it was definitely exciting for us as well. Other divisions have submitted, but Chesapeake is the first to be recommended for use. They have a morphology for grades six through eight supplemental program that is being recommended. Initially, it was just for their own use. It was going to be something that was approved in Chesapeake, but when we spoke to them recently, they have put together a pricing guide so that it will be available for use, and if it is approved, after that, the pricing guide will be available for other divisions to use as well. Okay, so the Google Drive is after they pay the price, and they'll have access to it on the

[01:33:21] Google Drive. That's correct. And my second quick question, I think, is I keep hearing across the country that states get a little confused when one curricula gets improved in one state and it doesn't in

another state. And so I think just going forward, if we could, and maybe that's part of your due diligence already, if you know like, okay, this has been approved in like 12 other states and not here, then or vice versa, right? I just think that that should be a flag because I think the curriculum community is starting to get it, that states are getting a little annoyed, like, you know, why is this, you know, the publishers are obviously getting

**[01:33:58]** annoyed because they don't understand the criteria, and presumably we should start having some similarities in these criterias across state if we have a common definition of high quality, and I believe we're getting closer to that. So I guess I'm just asking for your feedback on whether that's one of the criteria that you look into, if another state is approved or not, and how you think about that in terms of trying to be consistent across states?

**[01:34:21]** Sure. So part of our development when the rubrics were developed in 2022 is that we worked with other states. So our rubrics are based on Louisiana and Colorado in particular, but then because we live in Virginia and we have the Virginia Standards of Learning, our rubrics are not the same.

**[01:34:40]** So our rubrics in Virginia are aligned to both the Virginia Literacy Act and to the Virginia Standards of Learning. One of the big pieces that remains consistent among many of these states that are doing similar work to ours is that we are looking at science-based reading research and evidence-based literacy instruction.

**[01:35:00]** So that is a common theme, but I do think that one of the things that you are hearing and seeing is that our rubrics are aligned to Virginia Standards of Learning. When you look at some other states and how they report out, many of them use Common Core, which we do not, and so that is also one of those differences.

**[01:35:19]** there any other questions here then we thank you and we will accept this item for first review and see you back in November thank you very much okay that moves us G and H just for right for I thought it was a written report okay

**[01:35:43]** dr. Hollins all right I'm just checking to see if our PowerPoint is right you

**[01:36:25]** guys can see the PowerPoint correct all right we'll go ahead and get started Dr. Murray all right good morning president Gretzky and members of the Board and Superintendent Galixson, sorry, that'd be great, thank you so

**[01:36:47]** much. We're gonna go ahead and get started, if y'all could just follow along with the report, we'll make sure the slides are updated.

**[01:37:56]** Good morning again, just as an introduction, the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act of 2004 requires states to have an advisory panel. The SEAC advises the Department of Education and the Board of Education, And I want to state that the majority of our members are individuals with disabilities or parents.

**[01:38:16]** And then Code 300.167 states the Virginia State Special Education Advisory is established in accordance to Public Law 108.446 under the Individuals with Disability Education Act, the Virginia Conflict of Interest Act, and the Virginia Freedom of Information Act, and the requirements governing special education programs for students with disabilities in Virginia.

[01:38:42] So our SEAC meets four times of year as a full committee. We meet quarterly. We met in July of 2024, September of 2024, December of 2024, and then again in March of 2025. We have two executive committee meetings each year that are the day before our SEAC meeting.

[01:39:03] Our subcommittees meet during each session to discuss issues that are going on we're concerned about and our meetings are open to the public we have standing committees we have the executive committee the nominating committee we have a policy and regulation subcommittee student achievement and outcomes subcommittee and a family engagement and community outreach subcommittee and our members of the SEAC each serve on one of those sub committees during our meetings we have presentations and these presentations come from the discussions of the subcommittees that drives what we ask to

[01:39:41] have our presentations on so we had our annual plan review finance meeting we had an ombudsman report we look at state indicator data vocational educational transition services project hope parent educational advocacy and training our annual report dispute resolutions we looked at the Virginia Literacy Act as well as foster care services this last year one of the things that our constituents are responsible for is to bring constituency reports to each of our meetings we all represent a various

[01:40:17] constituents across the state some of these concerns that were brought forward this year was concerns about school safety staffing shortages general education teacher reluctance so really thinking about the general education teachers teaching our students with disabilities and the knowledge that they have in their training programs bullying concerns behavioral health resources, high absentee rate for our students, language barriers and translation services. We also talk about parents lack of understanding about special education process and how do we help our parents know more about what to

[01:40:57] do, and then diversifying teacher recruitment, licensure, accreditation concerns. So those are just some of the topics that we've talked about, some of the concerns that constituents have across the state. In our subcommittees, we really talked about teacher shortages transition services paraprofessional development making sure our paraprofessionals really know how to help our teachers and educating our students cell phone accommodations was a big one with the change in cell phone usage in schools and how that impacts our students with IEPs and then local special education advisory committees

[01:41:36] just not all divisions even though they're all supposed to have special ed committees are reflecting or have active committees and that can then impact our students. So a concern for that. We talk about our recognitions and commendations for people and for the work that has been happening. One of those is our recognitions of our members who have served on our board. We really commend the Department of Education and the board for their support. We really thank you for that ongoing support. Updating eligibility documents and

[01:42:15] making them family-friendly. We really want our resources to be family-friendly and that's a really big concern, you know, concern and consideration that we want to make sure that it's happening for that partnership, that true partnership to happen between professionals and families. And then we talk about partnerships and initiatives and there's lots of numerous partnerships and initiatives that are supported by the board and VDOE. We want to thank you for and some of those include our grow your own programs where we're really working to have paraprofessionals obtain their associate or their bachelor's degree so they can go on to become teachers because we believe that they're going to

[01:42:51] stay in the divisions where they are located the continued use of gov delivery in order to get information out we have a you guys support the aspiring special education leaders Academy and that's a great thing one of initiatives that's our opportunities that's out there that we are really excited about as a new I'm determined Center that's housed at JMU and then just the ongoing partnerships that are out there between us and the board and the Department of Ed with CEC Center for Family Engagement the Autism Center for Excellence again we're about wanting to help our students and improve their

[01:43:27] outcomes um each of our subcommittees came up with some recommendations one of those is regarding teachers we looked at like some themes for you all and thinking about standardizing teacher pay we're seeing a lot of teachers jump from division division because they get signing bonuses and that's not helping the divisions where teachers are leaving so that was one of the considerations that we had the other was a special education pay scale that would be differentiated again for the work and recognizing the work our special educators do to improve the outcomes for our students with disabilities expanding professional development for educators and then

[01:44:07] streamlining licensure processes it seems like licensure is taking a long time to happen and recognizing that so just some streamlining of that process recommendations for student and parents gathering classroom age data the age range of students and self-contained classrooms sometimes can be large and we would just want to ensure that our students are getting the best opportunities and the best education they can they're being served appropriately one of the things we really talked about is adding a QR code to Virginia IEP at the end for parents to understand

[01:44:41] about the state SEAC so that they can get involved and their voice can be heard along with that is updating the VDOE website to make it easier for parents to find information about the SEAC if you search SEAC it doesn't come up easily and so making it easier for our parents we want them them to be able to get engaged providing transition reports sorry sorry having in transition school representatives involved in our IEPs is really important we really need to talk about those transition services for our students so we make sure that we are implementing things that they need

[01:45:18] moving forward and then improving and progress monitoring reporting we want the progress monitoring to be more meaningful right now the progress morning for our students with disabilities says sufficient progress and there's really no quantifiable measure on that can be very subjective so having it more meaningful like we do for our general education students with measured percentages in conclusion students with disabilities need to be prioritized the SEAC recommendations are guides to the Board of Education and we encourage

[01:45:54] public participation and transparency and I just wanted to take a moment the SIAC at our last meeting and talked a lot about the cut score so we were appreciate the time that you're taking to listen to stakeholders input on that as we think about our students with disabilities with those raise cut scores thank you any questions are there any questions here Dr. Northern and then Dr. Ackerman or vice versa either way you mentioned the local special education committees are meeting on a regular basis but I'm not quite sure I saw that in the recommendations is there a recommendation on I don't know if that

[01:46:33] could tie into some of the accreditation talk that we're having or sure thank you so much dr. Ackerman I really appreciate dr. Murray's presentation you heard her note that one of the concerns of the state CX has been helping to support local CX and so in partnership with the state special education advisory committee we've also instituted some professional development and technical assistance to

school divisions including an online on-demand course for local CX and we also have staff boots on the ground that are available to train on-site for those committees to come together so I think the biggest thing is just an increased focus and communication of that need to school division leadership in particular

[01:47:12] and keeping maintaining the resources at the department to help support that okay thanks I just want to jump in and say I think just making sure we get that information to parents I think that that's sort of sometimes the gap we created um postcards in our division um to give out at iep meetings and i asked a parent who came one time and they're like oh we just got this and i'm like you just got this and the child had been involved in special education but it was like three years after we had done the postcard so really just making sure everybody's talking and telling parents about the importance of them being involved in their local cx okay yeah and i think as we talk about accreditation maybe there's some

[01:47:49] some things we can do here to help but i also want to and and this isn't really a question it's just to give more support on that provisional license issue i'm not even sure you know this i'm probably should have raised this to you all not necessarily right now but now that issue is so critical for some programs in schools that it actually can hold student receiving services so i know for example in some of the private day type facilities you have to have a certain amount of teachers that are licensed to accept new students so as we have submitted provisional paperwork and it can take three sometimes three to six months to get that back we can have students

[01:48:28] reading waiting for services for three to six months so if there's something we can do to kind of elevate provisional license I mean not that all licensure is important but but to elevate it above the standard license that are maybe coming from colleges and they might not even have the jobs yet but elevate those teachers that are in the classroom waiting for those license I think could be something to consider but to streamline that process is critically important I think for our field absolutely and the state CEC has heard a lot of comments on that we also have a private school provider who sits on the State Advisory Committee so you've heard Superintendent Gullickson talk quite

[01:49:05] passionately about updating the technology and infrastructure at the department to support that but we also stand ready in the Department of Special Ed and Special Populations to help support our private school providers and streamline those candidates for licensure as well that's all I have for I might have more after your comments back to northern so I am all about this second recommendation from the teachers about special education pay scale having that differentiated I think that a lot of folks understand that offering higher pay in high-need schools or with teachers who are teaching our students

[01:49:44] with disabilities you know those can be tough jobs so I'm wondering if there is a division across the state that may be an exemplar that's already doing this it's doing it really well I mean these are the types of policies and practices we like to hold up and say okay what can you learn about this do you see an impact relative to your retention or recruitment of high quality special education teachers dr. another great question the state CEC also has a representative of a local superintendent and special ed director currently that the special ed directors from Stafford County and Boosh and they do have some great examples there are regional folks are working to pull together you heard

[01:50:22] dr. Murray mentioned grow your own projects and programs across the state so it's part of our job at those regional sped directors meetings to make sure that those connections are being made in those practices that are really helping to improve hiring and recruitment and retention could be shared and mirrored across local school divisions particularly on a regional basis okay yeah I mean if there's a

particular one I know soon as we hear from divisions we know and we want to hear what good things are happening across the state. If we've, you know, got a particular division that warrants coming to us and telling us how they got that done and how it's been working, that'd be great. So thank you.

[01:50:58] Other comments or questions? So one of the things that I would like to add is maybe some more understanding of who can be participants in both the state and the local SEAC committees, Because I do think that, I mean, I've seen my own division's SEAC application that's gone out, and it is very specific that you must either be a teacher in the division or a parent with a child with special education needs.

[01:51:36] While I think that's important and those are the populations that we are serving and teachers certainly need to be involved, I do think that we need to start taking a bigger, broader look from a community aspect at that.

[01:51:52] You know, I think community members being able to be a part of that committee to, it just brings a different perspective, perhaps. And oftentimes, maybe that community member is a parent of a former special education student in that division.

[01:52:13] And maybe some broader understanding, there's been quite a bit of consternation in my local school division over particularly how those SEAC members are chosen specifically by one central office employee. And so I think there needs to be a little bit better communication. So maybe something about that that you all can can be the liaison for would really be helpful. I don't know if you want to speak to that now or but but I just I did want to bring that to your attention because there's quite a bit of consternation in my school division about that. Yeah I think that's

[01:52:50] great feedback and i'll let dr murray weigh in but something that you know under her leadership of the state cac we've also enlarged our participants on the state committee to include military connected families you heard me mention private providers higher ed faculty members obviously with dr murray herself so we see the importance of that at the state level so i think it'd be a great topic for us to take back to the group to discuss further as well yeah and i would just want to echo that i you know agree like more involvement than my local cac i sit on it as a a higher ed representative as well at the local level and we have individuals from some of our community agencies who are part of that so I think it really

[01:53:25] depends on the local area but again keeping that word the messaging out there right so that people understand that it's not just parents and teachers the primary people do need to be our parents as we're representing them but again getting that input from other agencies that support our students and I think it's important for the community to be a part of it also because they they will likely be employing those students and so that understanding and that collaboration is really of highest priority so thank you I appreciate that

[01:54:01] are there any other comments here okay thank you all so much for being a part of the meeting today and then mr. gillstrap are you coming back up for us hello again I did mention this report in my previous presentation just to clarify a few things about it there are in your in your boilerplate you have a

[01:54:38] list of the types of information that is asked it's a long list I won't read the list to you don't need me to do that and we also did have 100% of our EPPs complete and participate in this process which is not always the case but We were able to get 100% participation.

[01:54:57] Once this is received by the board, it'll go into our Build-A-Table. All the data that you see in the actual report will go into the Build-A-Table for anyone to search and manipulate however they would like

to view the information. Does anybody have questions for Mr. Gilstrap on this report?

[01:55:16] I do have some kind of historical questions to ask because I think it's important, despite the fact that we do have all of these pieces that institutions of higher education have to respond to as far as their EPPs, I really would like to see trend data if we can do that, where, you know, if a particular EPP, you know, five years ago had a higher enrollment in that particular, you know,

[01:55:54] if we do k5 612 whatever in those endorsement areas i'd really like to see what that kind of trend data is looking like because i'd like to be able to have the board compare you know are we seeing a real movement away from the typical epp in you know with the higher rates of provisional licenses that we're seeing you know is it where in other words are we are we getting students who may be going through an undergraduate program and something totally different than an educator prep

[01:56:30] program and then deciding once they've graduated that they want to grab onto a provisional and go down the education route and in that case it may be cheaper or easier for them to get their licensure in via that route so i think some of that trend data traditional versus alternate pathway I can share a little of that with you verbally right now.

[01:56:53] Of course, depending on how extensive you would like to go, I could present that to you whenever you would like. I will say that it does say in the report that we are 4% down in EPPs than we were the prior year. I will also say that that is the trend across all colleges in all degree areas.

[01:57:12] It's not just education. But even if you were to go back to the JLARC report a couple years ago, It did report some of that data from, I think it was at least five to 10 years before where they showed the trend of education preparation programs had a peak and then they started to come down and that coming down corresponded directly with the increase in provisional licenses and increase enrollment in alternative programs.

[01:57:37] If you were to ask me, what do I think the reason for a 4% decrease beyond possibly just the general trend of people not going to college as they used to, I would say the alternative route, just for example, we have anywhere between a thousand and 2000 people coming through the I teach program, which they would not necessarily go through an education preparation program and they would have in the past, they would have maybe had a degree in something else and then decided they wanted to be a teacher and they would have gone back to college, got either a second degree or completed that.

[01:58:10] So I would say that a lot of the trend is that way and we will probably see that trend continue just because that is more cost effective for those that are attending and it's a career switching opportunity yeah i think i would be really interested in um you know given those trends how are how are we as a board um communicating with abtel that this is not you know 20 years ago educator prep program process

[01:58:46] that we really need to start thinking differently about the programs that we are approving or that abtel is sending to the board and so i think that's a message that we certainly need to make sure that we're communicating to them strongly from from this angle president greece i i spoke to the directors of education preparation programs earlier this year and in that in that address i had to them one of the things i made a suggestion to them was that they learn from the models of the alternate programs that they have the ability and probably the ability to produce even higher levels of graduates through an alternate pathway if they were to go ahead and commit to that with

[01:59:25] the program that they already have. Well I would argue that this trend is very similar to what we saw you know 25 years ago when we started seeing satellite major university programs in educator well in licensing in general preparation programs so not full ed prep programs but this may be that new wave um dr northern yeah i think i'd um i i would appreciate like a presentation i think with some slides on exactly what they're reporting as i as i look through the

[02:00:00] 77 pages here um i do think that um what i care most about are what our teacher candidates are being taught right and so i know that nctq does a report on you know how what are our candidates who are going to teach elementary reading being taught are they actually being taught the science of reading and similarly I want to know that our teacher candidates are being taught to the standards of learning if they plan to stay in Virginia and and are they being prepared to teach to this higher quality of standards because we know that you know we've we've upped the ante in our expectations so I don't know what that would look like you know whether it would look

[02:00:37] like an you know additional conversation with these folks with our teacher educator preparation programs if it would look like you know them providing us with information assurance that they are actually teaching the science of reading and are teaching to the Virginia standards of learning we do gather that information that is part of what we do every year with we have a cycle of evaluation of universities Dr. Torbert my director of teacher education that's what she does she does the standards checking she works with our instructional teams to make sure that the instruction that they provide whether it's they provide it to us through their syllabus course

[02:01:15] descriptions actual observations cape visits also provide some of that information but we do have all that information um and and we can provide it to you in a report if that's where you'd like or a presentation whether or not however you would like it yeah i would like to invite her to join me with that since she is the boots on the on the field but uh yeah yeah no i'd welcome I think it's a conversation we're having all across the country, you know, that to the president's point, you know, how do we better prepare?

[02:01:46] Because we're in such a, you know, a dire place in education. And so I do think that teacher education programs need to step up and do things differently than they've done in the past. So to hear about our efforts in that way would be helpful to me. I will say, Dr. Northern, I'm sitting on Abtel now.

[02:02:02] And so one of the conversations in my first meeting was about a program that the committee was not certain was aligned fully yet with the Virginia Literacy Act. And so there was a lot of conversations around that.

[02:02:20] I'm certain that that sense has rectified itself. However, I'd like to respond to your second part. I've always thought why do we have we have law schools in the Commonwealth of Virginia and they teach Virginia law right we are educator prep programs in the Commonwealth of Virginia we should be teaching how you teach what you teach for Virginia specifically right I'm not saying we're teaching to you know teaching teachers to go in a classroom and teach to a test but there are things

[02:02:57] in virginia much like if you go to south carolina or new jersey or california or wherever that they want for their teachers to know to be able to impart on the students in their classrooms and so i do think that you know we have to take a different approach to education particularly in the traditional programs where we are saying you know we this is a full educator prep program we're giving you pedagogical content we are giving you your curriculum type content all of those things and we're teaching you how to do to be a teacher in virginia and you know it's got to go and get a

[02:03:36] license in a different state once you get your license here in virginia because you've graduated from an educator prep program here and you move to a different state well you have to apply to be get to get that license in a different state so i don't i think that's another thing that we should probably take back and talk very very significantly about at the abtel meeting madam president dr ackerman i'm just curious because i um do the alternative programs have these same requirements of making sure the teachers are teaching to the sols or that they're cape accredited or because i think that's been some of the in my background in higher ed some of that bit of attention right like they don't have the same standards that

[02:04:16] we're required to meet so it makes it harder than to offer those alternative type pathways so I don't know if you can speak to that now or I can say something yeah I don't know if I can answer it fully I will say that both alternative programs and education preparation programs are required to prepare the students based on Virginia standards that is a requirement that is what we measure them on and we've even had discussions where is it okay to do student teaching in another state if you're going to teach in Virginia and we have decided that that is okay as long as we are still basing everything on our Virginia standards so for the alternative programs one thing you need

[02:04:54] to make sure you keep in mind is the name alternative program means that we are doing something different than what we would do in an education preparation program we just want to make sure that that difference is it a detriment to our students so there are other things that they would maybe have to do to substitute for those things so let's say that they maybe they only do 10 weeks of student teaching in an education preparation program but they're getting a whole lot of other things through the program a lot of these alternative programs go a full year of student teaching so there's a compensation for some of the changes and those that full year is within a Virginia school so

[02:05:30] they're all obviously exposed to Virginia standards Virginia assessments things like that and I fully support them especially in the field of special where there's so many shortage that alternative but it's just i know that some of the barriers that higher ed prep has to trying to come up with alternative ideas is that they have kind of another set of standards um so this is really good helpful information i appreciate it yeah and there's some neat partnerships i i want to second what dr northern said earlier uh about some of these special ed partnerships because this is when these two silos come together um where i know know they're doing some really neat community college partnerships for the

[02:06:08] paras so it'd be neat to kind of hear a presentation I think on some of that really innovative stuff that's happening out there. Mr. Green did you have a comment? Okay Mr. Monk? I guess two questions one self-reported correct because I you know look it through and like Dr. Northern looking at 77 pages some I'm assuming are doing some elaborate surveys with employers and graduates. Others appear maybe not so much to be doing that. It maybe seems to

[02:06:42] be more anecdotal. What is what is the institution required to do with this information or is it just summative? Well number one they had to present it with this report so that's one thing they had to do. They also include that information in their cycle reviews that they do every seven years. Right now university EPPs are on a once every seven years to decide whether or not they maintain their accreditation with the Board of Education and so that is information per year and over the course of the seven years that they include with their report and that's also part of their CAPE visit so when they

[02:07:22] maintain their CAPE accreditation they also have to provide that type of information and some of the ones that were you're seeing maybe there's not as much data there it could also be in programs that

are very small and so their data set is probably fairly small where those that have huge data sets maybe have a much more vast amount of information to pull on if I may just a follow-up to that you know some of again everyone is the response is a little bit different based upon the narrative there but you know I'm seeing some that say 16 20% of teachers are somewhat ready when you go in or when

[02:08:00] the entities go in to do those reviews, what type of additional or changes are made to kind of follow up on that? Because I think when we look at, from a state perspective, maybe 15% of a cohort, that's a few folks, but when you multiply that across all EPPs, you know, we've got a challenge then of, are those folks in the workforce that aren't really prepared to be in the workforce?

[02:08:27] And so I know that this isn't really our purview, but want to make sure there's some time this data is used in some way to further enhance. Yeah, yeah. And further on that, I'd really like to touch on, I guess, really the how we are verifying the quality of clinical placements.

[02:08:55] So our student teacher, our student teaching time is a semester long enough. I mean, let's I do think that needs evaluation. And I guess we need to we need to look at what the quality, how we are verifying quality of a student teaching placement.

[02:09:20] I mean, you hear stories from all over the state that people's experiences are vastly different, one from another. That might have to do with the quality of the cooperating teacher or what the placement is.

[02:09:38] But I do think that placements need to be evaluated and how we are able to gather the information about the quality of student teaching placements. So maybe add to that that we really do need some strong information about.

[02:09:57] Because, honestly, we are not doing a service at the state level by requiring student teaching for licensure if it is not A, quality, and B, truly preparing those students to go into that particular workforce.

[02:10:15] So, Dr. Northern? Sorry. Clearly this has struck a chord on the board because I think all of us recognize the importance of our teacher preparation programs and, you know, in making sure our teachers are just high quality and prepared. I'll add another PS, thinking about my own teacher prep many, many years ago, and others may have similar stories.

[02:10:38] I mean, I wasn't taught how to, you know, hold high expectations in a classroom, so I had no idea what that meant. So grading assignments, like how do you figure out, like, is this A, B, C, D work? How do you, you know, maintain a grade book?

[02:10:54] How do you keep classroom management? Like, because teachers have a really hard time with classroom management. The first year I wasn't taught the first thing about classroom management. So there's so many sort of just nuts and bolts thing. It's, yes, we need to know that they know how to teach and they need their content, you know, expertise.

[02:11:10] They need to be teaching their Virginia standards. But it's also those nuts and bolts things that you really need as a teacher. So I guess just for all of us to find a little bit more about what our teacher prep programs are doing and to really be able to have an opportunity to give some feedback there because we know it's not an easy job.

[02:11:31] I mean, I really do think that we have to be looking at student teaching in particular. I mean, I second your comments. Like, there were so many things that, you know, you either sink or swim. is is kind of how they tell you when you come into your first first teaching job and we we have a wonderful cte pathways program of apprenticeships and all of the things that we have set up in that world those things have to mesh like the things that we're learning from how we are preparing

[02:12:08] kids in high schools to be able to go into the workforce that's absolutely what we need to learn from in preparation for a teacher to be leaving you know the confines of higher education and going into the workforce. I mean one of the positives to career switchers is that they've been in the workforce and they sort of know what workforce expectations generally are but nine times out of ten we're taking kids out of EPPs and they're going straight into a into their first real job as a teacher and they're not getting the same kind of supports and understanding of

[02:12:47] you know the real adult workforce at the time so I just think that there's a different different direction that we have to take to get the preparation the words got to be stronger than preparation in order to ensure that our students coming out of EPPs feel confident in going into a classroom themselves I wanted to add and we had a discussion at lunch yesterday kind of on the side about about entering the workforce and how significant it was to not only have the hard skills but have the soft skills and

[02:13:26] that's exactly what we're talking about with with education for teachers because while it's validly important that they have the hard skills of what of the knowledge of what they're going to be teaching students the communication skills and all the soft skills that go with that are equally important and I do do think looking back many moons ago as you were alluding to although mine's further than yours you know you weren't really taught those skills you either had them naturally or you learned to develop them but all those are equally important in classroom so that goes hand in hand what we were saying yesterday Dr. Ackerman thank you sir I'm like I actually used to be on the

[02:14:05] accreditation teams for CAPE and NCATE so but those are still required correct CAPE does require field experiences beginning in the freshman year so I mean from freshman to senior they're getting a lot of experiences and I've been on a lot of committees about a full year of student teaching and that if we ever do want to consider that which again I've been on some really neat conversations and see the benefit of it with the teacher shortages and the decline and people choosing that as a major it'd be really interesting for the board to couple that with some why choose a degree in education type campaign thank

[02:14:42] you I couldn't think of the word and they did that I think the board at the The Department of Education did something about 20 years, 20 years ago, like Become One. I don't know if you all remember that around here, but they did a big campaign to choose education. So I think if we're going to look at the standards and kind of add some things, we might want to do a big campaign around be a teacher and a year internship.

[02:15:03] So maybe we need some definition, too, around what those programs that are CAPE accredited, what they are able to use as field experiences. Because I think that might be really super broad.

[02:15:21] And I know for me, my program required me to have 15 hours clinical placement in a classroom per education course I took beginning day one, my very first one. Which that was enormously helpful for me going into my student teaching.

[02:15:41] You know, that may be something we want to look at discussing. I don't know. I just do think that with all of the demands, particularly, you know, a lot of our teachers talk about just the technology demands and everything else on top of the daily building of lesson plans and teaching your content, all of the peripheral things that go to your job, we really do need to give them, give our students who are even entering an EPP the full view because I'd also like to see data of students who enter an educator prep program

[02:16:19] and don't finish because you know maybe they get into their student teaching and get hit with a big brick wall going I didn't sign up for this I don't know but that's data that I think would be helpful for the board as well placement is I think placement can make or break yeah that student teacher's experience, as you're saying, and if it's not a good experience, they may walk away from education. So, and I know we don't have a magic wand to create that, but I'm sure a lot of thought

[02:16:53] has already been put into it, but that is very true. Mr. Monk? And we know that geography plays an impact in that placement, and so sometimes maybe there isn't as much put into that just because, hey, I'm near an institution of higher ed, I get these folks every year, you know, student all of that plays in, but then the quality, I would agree, President Creasy, I think that varies based upon the EPP program. Anything else here? Superintendent Gullickson. Thank you, President

[02:17:29] Creasy. I just want to acknowledge the State Council of Higher Education for Virginia's great work on their institutional backpacks. We have really tightened up our relationship. We meet in partnership with the agency heads of the Virginia Community College System, Executive Director Fleming, and then also the heads of the workforce agencies every other week.

[02:17:54] And so this conversation is very timely because they've put out some great stats on our four-year institutions across program alignment, performance, retention. And so being able to bring this information back to them that we'd like to see and make sure it's very clear on our teacher prep programs but also our principal and superintendent program pathways as well is part of that data collection because they've really been moving towards that ease for families and aspiring students to make sure that

[02:18:31] they can see what is the ROI if I go a certain pathway or program at each of our public higher ed institutions and so very timely and excited to help see how we can further illuminate in their existing backpacks on ways that would make it easier for the board to navigate as well through our already existing mou partnership thank you thank you thank you mr gillstrap sorry sorry we added to your workload but i think it'll be fun and enlightening good good good good okay mr

[02:19:07] jennings you're up thank you for your flexibility from yesterday afternoon to today we appreciate it same for miss velasquez who will come behind you appreciate it so good morning president creasy superintendent gullickson and board members today i'm going to be sharing an overview of some of the potential changes to the virginia's consolidated state plan i will be using the presentation from that was posted to yesterday's work session i'm going to note which slides i'm on and present and

[02:19:46] and pause as needed and take any questions. So my name is Mark Jennings. I am the newly assistant superintendent, very proud of that, of accountability assessment and best practices.

[02:20:02] And so with that, I bring sort of multiple offices and experiences to you today. And so on slide two, our outline for this presentation, I'm gonna give you a background of the Every Student Succeeds Act.

We're gonna talk about the purpose of seeking an amendment, the overview of proposed revisions at this time, and then the process and timeline for Amendment 9.

[02:20:21] So this is Amendment 9 of our Consolidated State Plan. So moving on to the next couple slides there, slide 4. The background you have is the Elementary and Secondary Education Act of 1965, known as ESEA.

[02:20:37] It is the primary federal legislation that governs division and school accountability and established the federal government's expanded role in public education. And since then, it's had multiple revisions or reauthorizations, and the latest was in 2015, The Every Student Succeeds Act, known as ESSA, and that was signed, again, Bipartisan Act, December 10, 2015.

[02:21:00] And so on the next slide there, you see an image of our Virginia's Consolidated State Plan and the number of amendments. States go through amendments as needed based on, well, and as you see actually at the top there, the goal of this plan is to simplify the application process.

[02:21:15] This was something that USED received feedback from multiple states saying, please make this process easier as you collect information on Title I, Title II, Title III, Title IV, Title V, and Title VII. And so that's what you get in this plan. And so you make amendments based on the different titles, based on, you know, revisions to perhaps Title I or Title II, just as needed.

[02:21:37] But as far as accountability goes, our work is very much embedded in this. This is how we satisfy requirements under ESSA. it's meant to be to provide the public with quality transparent information about how Virginia will meet the requirements of ESSA and so for us this year we're very proud to say we have a cohesive accountability system since you know ESSA passed we had we were following the law but we also had a state system and school systems were doing paperwork under both data collection under both reporting under both funding under both and so now with this cohesive system this plan really explains how Virginia's meeting ESSA

[02:22:14] and doing what the law requires, but also bring in extra measures the state would like to have. So as we talk through accountability, you'll see the bullets there on that slide. We talk about what is a small group size, you know, what is Virginia's long-term goals in reading and mathematics and graduation. We have all of our indicators that we talk about here. The federal language uses annual meaningful differentiation. Some of this was carried over from No Child Left behind. You have the identification of schools. That's nationwide under this. We talk about 95% participation. Federal law requires that each school will have a minimum of 95% participation

[02:22:51] of students taking the assessment. And then we talk about, and Deputy Superintendent Booker Dwyer, I think one of her many passions is about that school improvement piece, division improvement. How are we looking for schools to exit? Sustainability. They don't just exit, but they continue showing progress. So all of that is wrapped in this plan to meet the requirements, but also gives the state flexibility. And so we look to see, you know, the allowances that we have and the recent flexibilities from USCD. And so that's what you see in this plan. It is a very transparent public process. On the next slide, you'll see the indicators. So ESSA requires that

[02:23:31] a state system have minimum indicators. The first one's an academic achievement. We do have to report in these areas in reading, math, and science, which we do. Number two is, this is the wording from federal, but other academic indicators for elementary and secondary schools that are not high

schools. And so what they're trying to get there too is you have a school that does not have a graduating class, you need another academic indicator. And like many, many states, Virginia chose academic growth. Most states, that's what they chose. You could have chosen something differently, but Virginia chose academic growth and will continue to use that. Number three is graduation rates. We do have to use a four-year adjusted cohort. Adjusted

[02:24:11] there means we're looking for students based on when they entered their high school. So that's the adjustment we're talking about. And if students leave you and go to another high school, then they wouldn't be captured in your graduation. But it has to be four years. It is based on approved diplomas, which in Virginia are the standard and advanced. Again, the IB would be considered advanced there.

[02:24:29] Number four is we're looking at progress and achieving English language proficiency. So these are students who have been identified as English language learners. We're looking to see how much they're progressing year over year. We in Virginia do that K through 12. So we're looking across the entire K through 12 spectrum to see how students are progressing in their English language.

[02:24:48] And number five, states are required to select another indicator or indicators. And Virginia, as you see, these are the ones we have. Chronic absenteeism, like many states we use that. Advanced coursework we introduced last year at middle school with mathematics, 3E readiness. Many states have some sort of post-secondary.

[02:25:08] I will again highlight for you, I do present it to multiple states. Virginia is a leader in this 3E work. We continue to get questions around this and they're looking to see how we're doing our 3E indicator. And then we brought in six-year federal graduation indicator with applied studies.

[02:25:24] So we're looking now at students who do not graduate in four years, the additional two years, and then we bring in the applied studies diploma for our students with special needs. So in our next slide, slide seven, you know, why make any changes to our plan? We've made revisions in the past. We've made these amendments.

[02:25:41] Why would we need to do this again? Well, when we brought to the board previously the school performance and support framework, we did, the board made notes of items for year two and beyond. They made notes of, you know, this is where we are now. We're going to adopt this, but we'd like to continue to have conversations.

[02:25:57] So that is in the spirit of why to bring this amendment. Number two is when we wrote our amendment seven to the Consolidated State Plan, we did tell the Department of Education that we would bring an amendment based on data from this first year, that we needed to get baseline data and we would use that to do exit criteria and some other measures. And so we knew this amendment was going to happen. And then thirdly, as we continue to engage with stakeholders, we've received feedback. You know, it's the first year of full implementation after modeling and so we want to take that feedback from our stakeholders and you know be mindful of that and bring that to the board for consideration about these potential revisions

[02:26:37] and so i'm going to list these for you this today is meant to be a broad overview this is not even a first review and you'll see on my last slide sort of next steps we're just the goal today is just to be transparent to the public share what the department's looking at start doing more stakeholder engagement bring this into the conversations that we're having just so we do come back to the board I can bring you

some more public comments and just continue for the first and final review stages and so the first proposed change we're going to look at some calculation methodology that participation rate there's some requirements if your school is below 95% we're going to look at some of the requirements with that and really work to reduce the the requirements on

[02:27:16] schools and focus more on support than compliance secondly we have three performance levels at the high school or the end of course we're going to look adjust those calculations versus the elementary and middle schools with four performance levels. Number two, we do need a growth metric. We've used value added this past year and we've discontinued that. Previously we use what's called in the literature value tables or progress tables and you heard about that yesterday from our Technical Advisory Council. That was their recommendation to return to that for consistency and so I'll bring that those models to you and sort of what the data shows for your conversation. We've already been

[02:27:55] engaging with the public on that and asking their input and so again we bring that today for conversation number three advanced coursework so we signal this in the past we began with mathematics and we want to bring some other proposals to the board about you know what other courses might be used at the middle school for students who are ready and then when to begin those courses as we understand bringing high school courses will require changes in scheduling you know access some other concerns and so when do you begin those so you can sequence properly. Number four, we're looking at a new indicator in history, social science.

[02:28:29] We talked in the past about whether it's elementary, middle, high school, two of the three, all of the three, sort of some feedback on that and where those assessments might fit. Number five on the next slide, nine, you heard about this yesterday. We've been doing the integrated reading and writing component. It was introduced in 2023, became optional or operational in 24 and 25 and we need to finish with some standard setting what we would propose here is that in grades 5 and 8 it would be part of a readiness indicator and so we'll bring the percentages to you but the students are required to take

[02:29:06] this now it's being you know they've received some information on it but they would now receive a score and then that score will be used in the readiness indicator for elementary and middle schools number six there's been some conversation already, but we would just again open the conversation on 3E readiness.

[02:29:25] There are all three are listed there. It doesn't mean we're changing all three, just you know, for the public. We're not bringing all, you know, all those pieces up, but just looking, having conversation, because the goal was to balance the three of them. And so the board has signaled before it wants to have a conversation on JROTC. Many divisions have asked us to talk about that and how that might fit an enlistment, and so we'll speak specifically to that, but if there's any other items on enrollment or employment the board would want to consider I will share we had a stakeholder group very very excited about their work working with around employment for students with special needs it was something we heard around programs that help students with special

[02:30:04] needs get into to be career ready and to get into programs and so we had a committee over the summer meet and do some work and so I'm excited to bring that to the board have some colleagues who did that bring that and something we'd like to share sort of the definition those programs and the criteria and and have the board take a look at that number seven English language proficiency there's a new assessment it's called the WIDA alternate access these are for students who are duly identified both special

needs and English language learners and so they we need an exit criteria for this new assessment and progress levels how do you measure that because these students are duly identified number eight is one that we've gotten quite a bit of positive

[02:30:41] feedback on and as you look at these items you know the question will be these are good ideas when do you do this I will tell you what I've heard for number eight is now. The public again has been pretty pretty clear they like to move on this one pretty quickly and so this is talking about our students who are recently arrived. They've been in a US school fewer than 12 months and currently Virginia like most states does exception A and I'll give you the details on this the next presentation but the proposals to go to exception B and what that does is allow an extra year to measure growth for these students and so number nine again going back this was one that we needed data but we need to determine how do our

[02:31:19] comprehensive support and improvement schools comprehensive means the entire school has been identified how do they exit what what do we measure as sufficient exit criteria for these schools how do they what does progress look like and so with our data from the framework we need to determine that and then for our additional targeted support improvement schools the same with our data what do we look at to be these are student groups that are severely underperforming what does enough progress look like to exit for these schools what does sustainability look like and then 10 11 and 12 you see on slide 10 there these get into the work of school improvement and so as you see the

[02:31:57] note there school improvement is not a one-size-fits-all approach and so we want to look at some revisions to use data-informed strategies looking at the context of the school that leverages the the full breadth of opportunity in Virginia, such as seat time, flexibility, multi divisional online providers, extended school year, and the innovative approaches to instructional delivery or school governance. And so looking at all of those and thinking about what more rigorous interventions means, what is resource allocation reviewing, what is technical assistance mean? So this is a nice time when you open up your amendment to look at it holistically and address those items. And on my final slide there, slide 11, our next step. So today's

[02:32:34] timeline was just again continuing this conversation. We've been doing stakeholder engagement. We will continue. We actually meet with the Superintendents Association on Monday, and we'll have this conversation with them and get their feedback on some of these changes. We'll continue with superintendent regional meetings. We're scheduled for conferences. We meet with organizations. We have advisory groups to the department that represent all eight regions, and so they give us input on these. Open public comment will open by November 7th, and they'll see a draft of the plan to provide some feedback that will be announced in the Virginia education update and it'll be on the DOE website. We'll come back to the board November

[02:33:12] 13th to bring you a first review of the plan and proposed changes for conversation and then we're looking for final review at this time December 11th and then from there we submit to USED for their approval and go through any sort of changes that they request. Are there any questions or comments for mr jennings dr norther you're good okay well i mean when you come back to us will you have suggestions for all 12 of these yeah okay we'll give you we'll give you specifics

[02:33:49] based on the feedback from the field as we start these conversations we'll have data for you to look at some modeling what it means and then take your conversations and that's why it's a first review and it'll still be out for public comment we'll bring more public comment back to you but that's why we

want to come today just to put it again out there through as people think about and And I think for these, the biggest concern we're going to hear is what time.

[02:34:08] And for some of these, it's very clear. We're not saying 25-26, but others, they're asking, please do it for this school year. Even though the school year started, there are others that are saying we would like it for this year. So we'll bring those suggestions to you about what the field would say when to start these actions. I mean, I think just for me, I will definitely want to hear a little bit more about what our TAC thinks about value-added versus student growth percentiles.

[02:34:30] I mean, I feel like there are pros and cons of each. so thank you for that additional information will do other questions comment thank you mr jennings thank you okay question for the board do we want to take a five minute break now or push through j

[02:34:50] and then we'll break for lunch okay um okay that would be you miss velasquez so sorry that you are

[02:35:11] last again not after lunch so still morning good morning president creasy members of the board Superintendent Gullickson. I'm happy to be back with you to talk about my favorite topic of the SOQ, the Fundamental Foundation of Public Education in the Commonwealth. So very important.

[02:35:49] So you have the presentation, that was the last presentation on the agenda yesterday. So I'll be going through those slides. And of course the first slide on page two is the slides that we build off of every month on this presentation that outlines your statutory references in the SOQ should you need to consult them.

[02:36:11] So on slide three, in our last month's meeting, I received some feedback from you about topics that you may want to discuss. So I did some research on many of them and tried to lay out for you what your options are with those suggestions that you made.

[02:36:28] So the first item was a student safety issue related to background checks for faculty and staff in public school divisions. So, you know, I know that it's the boring stuff that I love, but I laid out for you the foundation statutes that are in the Code of Virginia currently related to background checks.

[02:36:48] Background checks are currently not in the SOQ, so moving them into that would be a change that would require additional funding that we can talk about later. So I provide a few on page three of the presentation, the statute that requires all school division employees, permanent, part-time, temporary, to receive a fingerprint background check that's run through the criminal history records exchange in the FBI, and what the prohibitions are on who can be hired by a school division given what's in the background check.

[02:37:23] On slide three, excuse me, slide four, I laid out for you proposal options since the background checks are not currently in the SOQ. So right now you can, you know, if your recommendation is that you do not want to move them into the SOQ, you just want to amend the existing statute, I can draft language to put forth a legislative package that would affect that particular statute regarding background checks to require based on your recommendation renewal of background invest criminal history checks

[02:38:00] whether it's every three years every five years upon license renewal staggered based on date of hire so school divisions don't have to do their entire employee population at one given time and bear that now under the current statute the expense of the background checks is borne by the school divisions and

they can pass that expense on to the future employee so if you decide that you want to recommend amending the existing statute that is something for you to consider whether that would remain an expense borne by the school division for

[02:38:37] the renewed background checks or whether you want them to be able to pass that on to existing employees if you decide to move it into the SOQ then that will require additional state funding and basic aid in order to, since it would be a part of the SOQ funding model.

[02:38:55] I did not obtain figures on that because I first wanted to get what your recommendation was on the cost. Either way, it's going to have a fiscal impact, whether it's a fiscal impact on the school division or fiscal impact on the state, both, because obviously SOQ funding has a state component and a locality component. The one thing, there are background check requirements for your early learners um that that would not be in the soq so i didn't add those here but if you decide that you want to amend the existing statute rather than to move the background checks into the soq i would

[02:39:31] then add in those components for renewed background checks for our earliest learners as well so our early learner employees already have a five-year repeat right so it would essentially be bringing our k-12 employees into the same requirement but you're just saying that what what would what that would do is we would need to do that statutorily to move k-12 employees into that same those same existing recheck requirements as as early childhood employees well we wouldn't need

[02:40:07] to move that the k-12 employees into the early learning statutes we would simply amend the the existing but i didn't you know if if it's not moving it into the soq which only affects k-12 then we want to make sure that they align background checks for the early learners as well as for um school district employees and i believe there are background checks for private schools if you want all of them to align and the only question is it you know with the early learners there's the five-year repeat background checks if you wanted to shorten that for the k-12 then we would want to align all of them you know but if you want it on a five-year cycle to be

[02:40:43] consistent then we probably wouldn't have to amend that propose amending that statute so but i do want if you make that a change in the timeline of that renewal we want to make them consistent so those are the options i saw certainly if you see another option i'll be glad to um work on that research but that was where the options i saw it's a it will have a fiscal impact i mean we'll have to provide that analysis to the general assembly should the package go forward but it's a matter of amending something existing or purposely moving it into the SOQ.

[02:41:20] And what would be your suggestion? Well, I mean, I think the statute has existed for a number of years in its form now and has not been part of the SOQ. So, and those background, you know, I was a former school board lawyer, so the background checks take place.

[02:41:36] They catch things that they need to catch. So I wouldn't necessarily see it as a necessity to move it into the SOQ since it's never been there, but it's effective in what it does. But we certainly can modify the existing statute, polish it.

[02:41:51] If we see any other inconsistencies or any other weaknesses in it, this would be the time to fix it. So right now it says we require all school boards to require all applicants accepting employment to be fingerprinted, and the fingerprints are forwarded through to the FBI to obtain a criminal record.

[02:42:13] So remind me again what's wrong with the current process. Like where are we falling down here? Well, there's currently no renewal of the background checks that have been employed for, you know. So unless something is brought to a school division's attention, either through an automatic notice from the courts, something could fall through.

[02:42:33] Or through renewal of your license or through changing your employer. So it's not just one check. If you move from School Division A to School Division B, School Division B, upon offering you employment, would have to do that same check again.

[02:42:52] Correct. Any employee in School Division has to do the check. But if you're a long-term employee in a particular school division, 15, 16 years, and something has occurred in your personal life that didn't get picked up because a background check wasn't conducted as a renewed background check, you know, it's a risk.

[02:43:12] I don't know that it occurs, you know, exponentially, but when it comes to student safety, we can never do enough. Right. Madam President? Dr. Ackerman. But somehow schools are notified. Is it when it's child abuse or neglect that schools are notified?

[02:43:28] Because sometimes I do know that we get notification of a crime. You get notices from the courts regarding school division employees and certain charges, and you also get notices from DSS. And if a conviction occurs and they're required to register, God forbid, on the sex offender registry, you will get notices from the sex offender registry.

[02:43:55] But that was the weakness in the statute, that early childhood has the renewed criminal history checks. And the current statute that affects background checks are not. There's not a requirement for a renewed look every so many years. Thank you.

[02:44:12] Sorry. All right. So we wouldn't be changing the fingerprint thing. We'd just be saying every five years you have to get it done again. And it doesn't require another fingerprint because your fingerprints won't change, right? It just requires that that updated criminal history be. Right. And there's an expense associated with doing the fingerprint and expense associated with sending it to criminal.

[02:44:31] Well, and I will say there is still a difference in how the processing takes place because early childhood requires what's called field print or automatic fingerprint capture, whereas K-12, you can still run either a physical fingerprint card or do the automatic fingerprint capture.

[02:44:56] So we might want to also take the opportunity to streamline and make that consistent as well for that automatic capture. Because then it's going to be in a file so that it can easily be rerun.

[02:45:16] Whereas in a card, you lose the, you know, you just lose that ability to see clearly after a certain period of time. So you would have to recapture on a card the ink. Right.

[02:45:31] So, you know, I think that's, thanks for saying that because that just jived my memory on how do we go that route. Paper can go missing, paper can decay, you know. This is where you put your finger on like a little screen. Yeah, right. Versus having a bit of nasty ink put on your fingers.

[02:45:52] So that's the direction. If you decide you want fingerprinting and background strengths moved into the SOQ, then I would get with the finance office to see if we could estimate some costs associated with that. If you decide to amend the amidst, and what I do with the same thing, If you decide to focus on proposing amendments to the existing statutes, what type of fiscal impact that may have.

[02:46:21] But like I said, the existing statutes exist, and it's been successful and in place for a number of years with some modifications by the Assembly over the years for clarifications and such. But I say it is easier to try to amend something existing than to try and create something new elsewhere.

[02:46:43] Any other questions on this one before we thank you? Okay, so progressing on to slide five with student safety continued, the superintendent brought up with me after the meeting that there was also a question about school board members.

[02:47:04] And the fingerprint background check statute only applies to employees. It does not apply to school board members. And so, you know, most of our school boards are elected, so I do not profess to be an election law expert in any means, So I had to go down that research line, and it took me quite an extensive look at that.

[02:47:26] But usually, anybody who has had some past troubles, that comes out in the election cycle through the press. However, it is a bar to running for office if you've been convicted of a felony. Because in Virginia, you have to be qualified to vote to run for office.

[02:47:44] In order to be qualified to vote, you could not be convicted of a felony. Or if you have been, you would have had to have your rights restored by the governor. So the felony convictions are not so much a concern in terms of running for office. And then there are statutes in place to require a forfeiture of office if you're convicted of a felony while you are in office.

[02:48:05] So there are some protections there. Now certainly the appellate process would have to play out most likely if someone has been charged with a felony. So there may be issues there. But the biggest gap is that the forfeiture requirements do not apply if you are charged and ultimately convicted of misdemeanors.

[02:48:26] It doesn't bar you from running for office if you have a misdemeanor conviction. It does not require you to forfeit office if you are convicted of a misdemeanor while in office. But there is a process to remove an elected or appointed official, and I've laid that out for you, but it's kind of a cumbersome, complicated process.

[02:48:49] It requires a certain percentage of the voters in that area to sign off on the court petition, but there are places within the statute that allow for the removal for certain behaviors. Some of those behaviors in terms of offenses that we'd be really very much concerned about, drug offenses, sexual battery offenses, but it is not a broad capture of offenses, even from child pornography to those kind of things that would, for a school board member, we would need a heightened awareness of.

[02:49:19] So I laid that out for you in the PowerPoint on page six. And then the problem is there's not a way for you to fix that in SOQ prescriptions. You know, it would require amendments to Title 24.2 of the code election section.

[02:49:40] And so I gave out some options because if you want some heightened scrutiny, because inherently school board members are around children. You know, a member of a board of supervisors or so forth, a city council, may not have, you know, constant access to children in the way school board members do because just in the nature of their job, children are attending school board meetings, they're singing at events, you know, things like that.

[02:50:05] school board members attend football games and come into classrooms to read so there's more access and so if you if you desire some heightened level of scrutiny that's applicable to elected and appointed school board members i laid out some suggestions for you on how to communicate your concerns um that may you know bring that to the level of people who actually can't amend those statutes um certainly raising those concerns to the governor in a legislative package raising them the commissioner of the department of elect elections uh the board of elections as well as

[02:50:42] the chairs of the privileges and elections committees within the general assembly all places and avenues that you could pursue and the secretary of of administration is over the department of elections any or all of those could be a place to communicate the concerns that there needs to be heightened scrutiny for school board members in terms of those misdemeanor charges that could occur so melissa if i'm not mistaken school board members are simply part of the local elected official criteria within the code they are they are baked into that right so it's not there there is not a separate section that defines the requirements that you have to meet as a school

[02:51:22] board member so okay so go down this path with me uh are you or are you not considered a school board employee or a school employee school board employee as a school board member you are not you are not you're not an employee but you are subject to being you you are paid by the school division for your service is that correct yes okay so is that not by nature the requirement needing to be met by the code so the code says that full or part-time employees of a school or school division

[02:52:01] must be fingerprint criminal background checked and child abuse neglect registry searched, and those searches are against the currently codified barrier crime list.

[02:52:18] So based on the full part-time, does that not meet the criteria? I do not see it as meeting employment status, and certainly our council of record could provide more guidance on that. I mean, it's no different than general assembly members are provided for in statute to be paid and they're not employees either there are statutory measures that cover payment of elected officials for the you know the governor gets a salary school board members but they're not employees of that body and certainly Deb Love um our assistant AG is here

[02:52:51] okay yeah I just I think it's slightly different for you know this particular code section I would

[02:53:33] be interested to see how we would come down on that um but but I guess at the end of the day what what we would have to be essentially making a request for is a specifically new section within that election criteria that would require them to meet because i certainly would not want for a school board member being having the ability to be alone with children in a classroom reading for one reason or the other for them not to have to to be under the same requirements as the classroom

[02:54:09] teacher has to meet him or herself right so um I guess that's just my my comment there um you know and I wrestled with this as I was doing my research because as I thought through it but what if there if a official is required to have a background check where would that background check go right you know because they're elected you know so they're under the election law there are processes to remove them for certain behaviors but where would that background check go it wouldn't come to you as the Board of Education, wouldn't go to the school division because they're not employees of the school division.

[02:54:48] So what would be the effect of that? So that's why I explored the election law statutes to determine that may be the better place for some heightened level of scrutiny or standard for an elected or

appointed school board member.

[02:55:04] Mr. Mock. Appreciate it. And I think, too, your point about elections bring out some of these things, completely agree. The challenge, though, is in a potentially community where there's not – someone's running unopposed. And so once there's only one individual on the ballot, then that creates a challenge.

[02:55:24] Well, and there may be the need to further define it in such a way that says, look, if you've not met the criteria of the background check, then you can't go into the school and do anything. You can still sit on the school board, but you cannot go into the school, you know, where children are present.

[02:55:41] I don't know, I'm just kind of spitballing here. Yeah, I mean, it's a complicated area. You want heightened standards for individuals who have contact with children, but we also have the election laws in place currently and constitutional provisions in place.

[02:55:58] And so it may be that further reflection needs to be on that. It may be that we have some, perhaps the superintendent has the opportunity to speak with the commissioner of elect to talk about what options are available so that we explore it as further you know further research but it may not be ready for prime time to come back with any kind of composed letter but you know that was the thought that if you the board wanted to authorize you and the superintendent to move forward with some sort of letter to you know

[02:56:32] convey the concerns of the board that that may be the best option in terms of getting to that before elects radar yeah I mean without without opposition does anybody have opposition to us communicating concerns okay yeah when I initially started that research I thought to myself I am no expert election law what have I gotten

[02:57:11] myself into but you are now it was I am now I was it was an informative process of exploring those requirements so well but moving on we out from student sapien to student expectations, a much more pleasant topic, we currently have in our standards of learning, excuse me, in the SOQ, that school divisions have educational objectives that they have to meet, and one of those objectives is early identification of gifted students and the enrollment of the students in the gifted programs.

[02:57:48] And so I've walked you through the statutory requirements the school boards have to meet in terms of the gifted -- identifying gifted students and included your own board regulations related to the testing, assessment, and identification of gifted students on slide eight.

[02:58:06] And I'm not going to bore you with the statutory language, but in standard nine -- excuse me, in page nine, there's currently no mandated measure of gifted potential in the primary grades.

[02:58:22] And I know that that is near and dear to the heart of many of you about not just supporting our at-risk learners, but supporting our gifted learners. And so I obtained some great information from Amanda Nevetrel.

[02:58:39] She gave me the information. I don't take credit for any of that in the slides. And so in terms of next steps for supporting our gifted learners, the idea of providing a universal screener at a certain grade level in the elementary levels is a proposal to provide support in that area.

[02:58:58] And so she provided me with great information from the Fordham Institute on the fact that our gifted learners are suffering as well in terms of their NAEP results and that they're missing out on some of

the supports as well.

[02:59:18] And so Amanda gave me estimates on the cost that she had obtained for a universal screener, perhaps at the second grade level or third grade level. And so in the options that have been provided to you on slide 10, it speaks to incorporating that actually into the SOQ, because it's already in the SOQ about the requirement to identify the gifted by school divisions.

[02:59:50] And so that would be an actual amendment to the SOQ. And it, of course, would have additional funding, fiscal impact. But those figures are laid out for you at the bottom of slide 10 in terms of an annual cost that would go into SOQ funding models.

[03:00:14] Any questions here? Any comments here? Dr. Northern? So remind me again what Ms. Conway is using in grade 2. maybe i should i should know this um but is there something that we're already implementing in grade two that could be also used as a screener because i thought i had a conversation with her prior to this and she indicated that that might be the case but i could have probably not for gifted

[03:00:46] but the screener um yeah i'm not so sure a screener doesn't have to be tailored to giftedness I mean, from my understanding, and again, you know, I am a typist generally on a lot of things and not an expert.

[03:01:07] My understanding from Amanda Navetro is that it would be a tailored screening to try and get the opportunity for all kids to test. Because so many times the current process, whether it's inherent bias or not, it leaves out folks that should be tested and aren't.

[03:01:27] And so the universal capture of screening of all kids in a tailored type of screening would potentially identify more gifted children than we're identifying now. And, again, I don't want to speak for Amanda. I don't think she could be here today, but Dwayne McClary is here as well as Jenna Conway, I believe, or in the other room.

[03:01:48] But if not, I can find those answers for you and give them to you. Yeah, and maybe other states and districts are, you know, doing it wrong. But I do know because we at Fordham, we collect data on district practices to identify kids for advanced services, and many of them report that they use, you know, a standardized test that all kids take, you know, in second grade.

[03:02:11] And it's not necessarily to, you know, to ascertain giftedness. But I am no expert in terms of screeners for gifted. I just know that maybe some other places aren't doing the right thing. I don't know. Right. And I certainly am no expert, but our instructional team and...

[03:02:29] It's my understanding, I think, that divisions can choose which screener they wish to use at this time. And, you know, it might really truly behoove us to look at the option of having a screener that is statewide.

[03:02:49] And I would like to submit also that we not just screen at second grade, but we screen at sixth grade as well for future i think because we've had this conversation before um you know i um i'm still certified as a gifted instructor and was the gifted coordinator in our school division for quite a number of years and you know students that come into our schools with high levels of you know higher vocabulary um maybe even reading before they come into school

[03:03:26] they have a much greater ability to score very well on those tests and that's not always necessarily something that continues when they get to sixth grade and so in many cases you know we're

doing them a disservice by pushing them in ways that they really maybe need help in in or maybe need to be in a different level course by the time they get to sixth grade so i think um and and then you know we have students moving in and out of different schools around the commonwealth and you know for one reason or the other sometimes wires get

[03:04:04] crossed and students get placed into to classes that maybe was misunderstood from a different school division and i had a situation like that when i was teaching gifted um and we were like where is this kid's test and so it would be very very helpful if we had another screening opportunity in sixth grade where we re-screened everybody that came into middle school with that identification just to ensure the the continuity of the identification true and from what i understand it's not that school divisions are not screening but it's not mandated in the soq

[03:04:42] That is the difference, that by putting it in the SOQ, it would no longer be purely voluntary or optional from school divisions to screen at second grade or to screen at second and sixth grade. It would be a requirement that they would have to meet.

[03:04:59] While many school divisions are already doing it, and many school divisions are doing it at multiple levels. Madam President, Dr. Ackerman? And since some schools are already doing it, I'm guessing if the state gets involved, there's some money savings possibly for these schools that are doing it, right, because this cost was estimated at the state level.

[03:05:19] And then there's also sometimes, I think, not enough discussion or awareness of the different types of giftedness. So some schools may feel that they are doing it, but they could be missing some of the other types of giftedness as well. So some oversight, I think this is a good idea.

[03:05:36] Now, Chief Deputy Conway is here. Dr. Northam, you had a question about the tests that you used. Yeah, yeah, I mean, and Janae, you can, you know, I just found the data I was looking for.

[03:05:51] So we surveyed district coordinators in advanced education. And so 80, asked them how they screened the kids for potential advanced services. And this could be totally wrong. 87%, and this is a specific, 87% use the COG, AT, or the NNAT.

[03:06:11] 81% teacher referrals, and 59% use MAP or iReady, and then 58% use performance on state-mandated end-of-grade reading, math, social studies, or science tests.

[03:06:28] I guess I'm just trying to figure out, like, you know, people are using a variety of tests across the nation to identify, and most of them actually do do it in second grade. That's another data point. And I was just wondering if there's an instrument in your repertoire that you think would be valid for this or not.

[03:06:47] Yeah, so I will speak less about kind of recommendation and more just where we are. So just as a reminder, the budget language established a VKRP 1.3 pilot and exploration.

[03:07:04] So we saw similar data in a survey that was conducted by the University of Virginia that was looking at less of what are we using for screening for gifted, but more around is there any apples-to-apples measure outside of either PALS at the time or VALS now that covers other areas of academic or social-emotional kind of progress for kids.

[03:07:29] And so that survey basically showed, in a similar way, a variation on what school divisions were using with some deficits in first and second grade, right? So you go from measuring the beginning and the end for VPI, the beginning, kind of the middle is optional, and the end for kindergarten.

[03:07:49] And then there's the kind of gap other than VALs, right, which covers all the way through, and then now up to eighth grade, and then you have SOLs. And so while the system expressed some trepidation about more assessment in third grade, because you have both the Virginia Growth Assessment and SOLs, they did note that there was a gap of statewide consistency on either screening or assessment, potentially even screening for gifted in the first and second grade.

[03:08:14] But that is still a budget item, and the University of Virginia in partnership with Deputy Superintendent Booker Dwyer and Assistant Superintendent Wallace and myself continue to support that work and we could also share the findings of that of that survey that would not be intentional to focus on gifted but that is effort to say you know should the state consider a more consistent screener assessment or something particularly for first and second grade right okay and so in your opinion jenna would it have to be a cog at or could it

[03:08:50] because i mean i guess i'm just seeing other states use a standardized measure that's not necessarily created to assess giftedness or is that do you know anything about that i would not be the expert to answer that question okay no worries thank you here's where the backup comes in so yes um so i recently was the supervisor over advanced learning and now um our new deputy superintendent mcclary is so we're tag teaming on this one um so this topic has been something that we've been looking at over the last year actually and um you know divisions are required to do a gifted plan it's usually for a period of two years um president creasy is correct

[03:09:29] divisions select their process their method and the data that was presented that you you read out loud certainly does share the different ways that divisions are identifying gifted i will say that most a lot of divisions i think over the last i'd say six to eight years probably have um done something similar to what president creasy said screening them first in second grade and prior to that if they screen like k-2 it's usually by parent recommendation it could be because the kid came in didn't go through public school and parents might recommend

[03:10:06] again like a third grade or a fourth grade assessment so based on parent recommendations they would be screened according to the gifted plan for the local school division and so then again they would test do kind of you know for kids who have not been identified they They would re-screen students, typically in fourth or fifth grade or in between there.

[03:10:28] And some do it later, like in the sixth grade. So depending on kind of what their division's setup is for their middle schools, because some set the middle school at fifth through eighth grade, and others set it sixth. That's not a requirement, no. And so, again, that's a division's option of how they do that.

[03:10:47] And then, again, there may be some late screenings after that, particularly you see that with students that are coming in as a transfer student from either another division a private school or home school situation where the parent wants their child to be screened for the giftedness and so the two most popular assessments are the COGAT and the Negliari and so you know certainly having one of those and really looking at what the data says and deciding that for the for the state would be an advantage so that we level the playing field for all divisions. If there was funding tied to it, that certainly would save the divisions

[03:11:24] money, but that of course would be a budget request because there currently is no funding that I'm aware of that goes strictly to gifted testing or gifted screening. And so, you know, that's something I know Amanda Nevitrol, the director, has been really working hard to reach out to school divisions,

particularly our rural school divisions and those school divisions that don't have a regular testing process she's just finished a series of training across regions eight and seven because they were areas where she saw need

[03:12:00] for support from the agency and so she just finished that work up about the time that the deputy came on board and I think she plans on doing that we she did it in partnership with English learner as well so those are two areas that we see needs so we provided on the ground support for those divisions? Currently, she has about 14,000 students calculated from just second grade that do not get screening because not having a universal screener. So about 85 district divisions in Virginia currently have screeners, and most of the others that don't are rural districts.

[03:12:35] And what do you think they're mostly using? They're using the Naglery and the Cogun. Oh, they are at their own expense? Yes. Okay, I gotcha. Which is why some of them may only screen and second grade because that could be a funding funding issue right i mean i guess i'm just wondering as a board whether it would make sense for i mean it's going to take a while right like if we want to try to get funding for the nagli area or the you know the cogat yeah um and so i wonder do we need like to like do we need to say okay you get flexibility use x y or z but this is a longer term plan we're trying to be more consistent she would recommend i think amanda

[03:13:12] would recommend like this is the list um and she could do a little bit more probably exploration she probably already has knowing amanda yes um on the cost of those assessments i think she's she's done that data already um and and has that available i think yeah one thing in kind of i'm a big local control guy and so recognize that maybe there's some districts that are are not doing it well and there's some opportunities there but i also think there's some districts that are doing this well and so I want to make sure that whatever we're talking about here at this level includes that thought process and really provides pathways for

[03:13:52] them if they're already maybe doing better even than some of the things that we can prescribe not limiting them in that but then also Dr. Northern you know there's some financial pieces here so is there something we're already doing that we can use as a screener just knowing that you know many of our students may not qualify so i think with limited resources we have we want to make sure that we're using those most effectively so i hesitate to do just this universal mandate across the board there no i think i think using the word universal screener is is more not we're going to screen universally and

[03:14:30] everyone gets tested i think it's just trying to get to more of a regulated test that is the same test that measures like like uh jenna was saying apples to apples instead of an apples to oranges um following you now yeah yeah and so i think that's the the the purpose here and i don't think it needs to be then everybody gets uh screened again moving into middle school years those that or had been identified previously should then be re-screened before that middle school transition

[03:15:09] so so melissa do you want to swoop back in here and kind of like bring this one to to kind of a close at what we want to move forward with as far as the board because personally i do feel like this is something that is good for the SOQ to address, so how do you want to?

[03:15:35] I mean, for this particular item, out of all of the items that we talked about last month, I think this is absolutely the most appropriate item to go into the SOQ, whether it's to universal screen at the second grade and then provide the testing, acceptable tests prescribed by the board via regulation.

[03:15:56] that's an option, and then also if there's an idea we can -- because you have broad regulatory authority in this area under the code already in terms of -- because you have existing regs that could be amended to prescribe the testing that is used at that second grade level, as well as who is tested again at the sixth grade level to incorporate the suggestions about once they have been screened and found and that they could be screened again as they transition into the middle school years.

[03:16:31] So it would fundamentally be a two-step process in terms of getting the SOQ statute amended and then prescriptions of the board in the regulations. But I do think this is the most appropriate item that we talked about last month for the SOQ prescriptions, and it would have associated state and local funding impacts.

[03:16:55] Is everybody on board with adding that additional screening process in this request to do, like? I would definitely want some more information around it, just knowing that from a dollar perspective what the impact is there.

[03:17:13] Sure. So can we close that loop next month then? Yes. It may be, you know, clearly the posse backup showed up for the lawyer in distress, but it may be better to have Amanda here to present and answer those questions as this is her passion, and she should have that ability to speak for that passion.

[03:17:37] And, you know, I can write the statutory language that affects the board's will, but Amanda can be the best advocate for that topic. So we can arrange for that for the November meeting. Okay, perfect. Madam President, Dr. Ackerman?

[03:17:53] Just for a point of understanding on the timeline, do we need to have this quality document revised by a certain time? She'll have the wording and we'll still investigate it at the same time.

[03:18:09] Yeah, I think Amanda will be here to provide the deeper explanations and advocacy on the idea, and I can provide you the amended statutory language to the SOQ. That is probably the least complicated part of this is amending the statutes.

[03:18:26] But I can draft the language, and that can be put before you to see if it provides the desires of the board in the proposed statute. President Greasy? Anything else? Oh, Dr. Northern. Just a broad reminder.

[03:18:44] I mean, the whole reason we do universal screening is to cast a wider net, right, because we think that some of the measures that we use actually don't identify kids who have a variety of talents. And so the one thing that happens with using the, you know, the COG-AT or the NA is that the non-Naglieri one, the N-N-A-T, actually is nonverbal, right?

[03:19:07] And because we do think that kids can, you know, do better on a nonverbal test. So I just would caution us, and maybe Amanda can speak to this next month, is when you say you want to standardize a test, it's actually not going to cast as wide of a net as we think it should because it's not actually picking up on different types of giftedness as well as multiple measures do it's not to say that we don't want to go that direction but I'm just saying that's that's part of why we're doing this right is to cast a wide net so I don't want us to be so narrow on the standardization front but maybe she can talk about the pros and cons and the trade-offs there next month in your current board regs have some multiple options in terms of

[03:19:46] identification a kind of a two of three measure but whether the statute would be the broad catch all to mandate the requirement that a test be administered in the second grade and possibly again a

sixth grade and then your regulations could articulate the those kind of things that capture the needs to provide diverse approaches to that identification Mr. Monk just quickly and and this may be some information finding for the next meeting, but the financial impact, would that be there if it was an already available test that's provided,

[03:20:24] you know, thinking a Virginia test, et cetera? It may lessen the fiscal impact, but there will be a fiscal impact to move from an optional testing screening to a mandatory screening of students at particular grade levels. Thank you on that one.

[03:20:50] I applied. Then the next item that was raised at the previous meeting was, I believe by Dr. Ackerman, about the teacher pipeline and some innovation that's occurring in a couple other states, such as Arizona and North Carolina.

[03:21:06] While my research showed the innovation in North Carolina is modeled after what is occurring in Arizona, but the project in North Carolina is currently stalled in the legislature. But my research showed that there's currently a project with the Arizona State University about teacher pipeline that has a very distinct model program in terms of preparing teachers and supporting teachers once they're in the classroom.

[03:21:38] We heard, you know, our board member, Mrs. Kilgore, speak to the fact that she wanted to stay in the classroom. She didn't want to, you know, advance up to administration in order to advance. She wanted to be that classroom teacher. And for those teachers that want to stay there, the need to support them and let them grow and advance within their classroom, that's important.

[03:22:00] And that's what the Arizona State University model is doing. And it's providing a program where it's very much a team approach. And that's on slot 11 for you, kind of, you know, read about the Arizona model and how North Carolina was also looking to that model to create its own advantages to a team approach in the pipeline.

[03:22:24] And so, you know, just as Mrs. Kilgore said, she wanted to stay in a classroom right now, there may be too little support being provided to teachers where they don't feel compelled to have to seek and go into administration in order to advance in their career. So, the creative ways that Arizona State appears to have used in terms of expanding the teacher pipeline, they have this new next education workforce model where they have, and North Carolina created their Pathways to Excellence model based on the Arizona State workforce development.

[03:23:01] But it's advancing those opportunities for the teachers to stay in the classroom, work with a cadre or team approach where there are less experienced teachers working with more experienced teachers, they're working with a set of students, for example, I think in Arizona or North Carolina it's like 100 students, they're in their cohort, so to speak, and the teachers are dividing their tasks based on expertise and based on things that new teachers need to learn versus what experienced teachers already know, whether it's communicating

[03:23:36] whether it's participating with parents, whether it's developing lesson plans, whether it's participating in IEP team meetings, that type of thing. So there's this level of support that the teachers always have access to, collaboration, and they always are working on behalf of the same students.

[03:23:55] So the students themselves always have someone to go to that's knowledgeable about what the entire team is working on. and so the compensation appears to be based on levels of experience and that

experience is going to grow in that team over their years of participation as a team and that compensation will grow with that differentiation of instruction and I'm so glad I got that word out the first time because I stumble over that every time but that differentiation is occurring because all of the teachers on on that team are aware of the same students

[03:24:33] and they're able to tailor instruction to meet the needs of that cadre of students. So I did not come up with a specific recommendation for the SOQ because I think this program is a bit in its infancy itself.

[03:24:49] It hasn't had time for all of the data to come out on its successfulness in terms of what it's doing for the teachers and what it's doing for the students. So I do, the recommendation here is more about perhaps exploration of the model program with the true instructional support team who are much better at that than I am.

[03:25:12] But exploring with Arizona State University what they are doing, perhaps a pilot program to stand up in Virginia to get it, you know, basically make sure it's up and running and working properly. And then to expand that on to whether it's multiple school divisions or all school divisions by incorporating it into the SOQ at some point.

[03:25:36] But because what's going to be needed, we're going to have to have a lot of cooperation. We're going to have to, because there's got to be a kind of change in the way of thinking. You know, Mrs. Creasy was speaking too. It's not the ed prep program of 20 years ago. It has to be the ed prep program needed for today.

[03:25:51] So we're going to need, you know, education prep provider or providers to participate, School board members in a school division who are willing to let that pilot occur in their division. School division administrative support who are willing to take their teachers and put them in a team that could be successful.

[03:26:11] Obviously, we want teachers, you know, who want to be there in that team. The students that would be assigned to that team of teachers, obviously financial support would be needed both at the school division level and the state level. And then, you know, we need to gather more information.

[03:26:28] both from Arizona and North Carolina because they're doing it and from within Virginia about how we can do it that best works for Virginia so in the options proposed there you know a possible pilot program but we would either have to on behalf of the board submit a request to the governor for inclusion in the governor's budget for the pilot or for even funding to explore what's needed to stand up such a program.

[03:26:58] Approval from the General Assembly if a pilot is where you want to go because it will require a budget amendment in the Appropriation Act. It wouldn't necessarily take a statutory amendment at this time, but a budget amendment to give you all and the department authority to move forward with that, and then those coordinations with the pipeline models like with North Carolina and Arizona, and then BDOE to stand up that process.

[03:27:24] So that was what best that I could find in terms of research that may work for you all to get the program in place and work it out the way that this board thinks works best for Virginia. And so it's a matter of seeking a budget amendment this year or seeking consultation and maybe presentations from the model that's being done in Arizona right now and what North Carolina is.

[03:27:52] So there's a couple of avenues, different avenues that you could pursue. Dr. Northern? So I think North Carolina's path is based on the opportunity culture, which is out of public impact.

[03:28:08] So I would suggest if we can get maybe some information from opportunity culture, because I'm pretty sure they were the ones behind the North Carolina model. And I thought I actually had a conversation with Secretary Guadera, and I thought she told me we had a division in Virginia that was doing some of these opportunity culture innovations.

[03:28:31] And I could be wrong about that, but we have one. We have one, okay. Okay, so they're just starting. So, yeah, my point is, yeah, that maybe we can hear from some pockets of, you know, in our own state that are doing some innovations around pipeline as a way to sort of get our juices flowing.

[03:28:52] Dr. Ackerman? And I agree with that. It would be great to hear more and maybe in partnership with our ed prep folks Because I suspect there's some barriers that we have in our requirements of EdPrep that prevent some of this innovation.

[03:29:11] So I think more information, you know, both hearing from innovative partners and having our experts involved in what that means in some of our requirements to EdPrep. Other comments on this? Thank you.

[03:29:28] And finally, in slide 13, there were other items raised at last month's meeting. I believe Mrs. McPherson raised lab schools in underserved areas. So the superintendent will arrange for a presentation to give you all a status update on lab schools and the map of the existing locations and who they're serving at the November board meeting.

[03:29:52] Mrs. McPherson also raised the school renovation prioritization of school construction issues with existing facilities versus building new and constructing new facilities rather than renovate the existing ones in existing communities and so partially that was addressed I think in the update to the school construction guidelines that you as a board have brought authority over because it's a budget item that gives you the authority to establish the guidelines and so there was something in last month's agreed-upon additions to those

[03:30:28] guidelines that does provide priority to using existing spaces versus new spaces whether it's to allow a CT program to utilize it or to allow a charter school to utilize it but rather than building new facilities now when this is new Pearson not here today I don't know she has any comments about whether that addressed some of her concerns but I'll be glad to you know work on that if that's a further direction from the board and then I believe mr. monkey may

[03:31:05] have raised the provision of the timely data and our data sources so the department has is working on things related to data right now so the superintendent is going to arrange a presentation on both CTE workforce data as well as a CIS information project from our assistant superintendent Paul Carmel and then of course student-centered funding formula is at the center of the department of the board's desires and administrations there's I have not seen much activity on that recently from the assembly but they're

[03:31:44] So once your prescription on the universal screener is transmitted and your other recommendations to the governor and the assembly, that your prescription document will include the continued support of the board for a student-based funding formula model.

[03:32:01] And lastly, my understanding is there are some desired enhancements to the school accreditation process that at our last meeting we're not ready for discussion, but potentially today I need additional information from the board on what direction to pursue for any enhancements for the school accreditation Mr. Monk and then dr. Ackerman. Sure. I think And this may be some of our conversations as well. I know on the academic side

[03:32:39] We have kind of a layout of an MOU of what that looks like to support Local districts thinking to the operation side Don't know if it'd be something that the board would be interested in of laying out some type of similar framework around What processes were to support local districts and their operational needs?

[03:33:00] You know obviously Melissa our our MOUs that we currently have are really more around student outcomes and You know, we need to look at the holistic view of the school division itself and the school itself not just from the student outcome perspective, but I um also their operational um effectiveness because inevitably that's that can affect student outcomes as well so um can we set up a system that drives much like what mr monk is

[03:33:34] talking about you know there are specific examples of operational concerns that um that you are speaking of that um would give me a starting point on on doing some research there yeah i think just generally come into mind maybe we've talked a lot about grants and finances and there's a lot of new money in education in Virginia so ensuring there there's some consistency and fidelity and reporting of information as well and making sure that the data that we've got is accurate timely and better informs

[03:34:12] the local decisions on the academic side but I think there's some some of those foundational operational pieces that right now aren't included in there madam president dr ackerman yes i and if i was dreaming i would love to see a process that's similar to what you think of when you think of typical accreditation where it's a panel and not just self-reported panel of peers um and again ma'am just because right why not shoot for the moon right because i think i was i was surprised to learn that the entire process is self-reported um but if you had some and honestly one of the neatest things about an accreditation process when it's somewhat of a jury of peers

[03:34:51] is you get to see other people's stuff, which is really cool. So you get to go to other school systems and learn from them and look at how they do this, that, and the other. How do they file all their fire drills for all their different schools? And so there's kind of a two-way opportunity, both an accountability-type opportunity for accreditation but also an opportunity to kind of learn from each other.

[03:35:15] But, again, if I'm dreaming, I picture more of what you, you know, when you think accreditation, that's what you kind of think of is, you know, a party or a panel visiting your school and just kind of checking your self-report is essentially what it is. But, I mean, that's just my two cents worth.

[03:35:32] I'm not speaking for the entire board, I think, when I say that. But now it's here. Dr. Norther. I just want to clarify. So because some of this stuff, like, I'm not sure belongs in standards of quality or not.

[03:35:47] So like something like, you know, innovating with teacher pipeline, I'm assuming if we wanted some new money, that's the rationale for it to go in the SOQ, right? Because like I see student safety, like I think of SOQs as like the bottom, like the inputs that you have to have to be, you know, a safe school and, you know, meet state requirements and all that stuff.

[03:36:08] So I guess if you can talk to me a little bit about how you see the difference of what goes into an SOQ versus not. Well, you know, over the years, there have been a number of things put in the SOQ from trainings to meeting the standards of learning when they were first put into place under the Allen administration.

[03:36:27] The SOQ is the fundamental foundation that school divisions have to meet. So sometimes I do think over the decades there have been things put in the SOQ that didn't necessarily belong there, but because they were put there, they became mandates that all school divisions have to meet.

[03:36:44] For instance, with the pipeline, I don't see that as an SOQ amendment, and that's why it was not proposed as an SOQ amendment. First, we need to gather a lot more information, but it would initially, I think, be proposed as an Appropriation Act, a budget item request to stand up, whether it be a pilot or a full program.

[03:37:06] And when things are amended and placed in the Appropriation Act, the language is not as specific as you'll see in a statute. And giving the department and the board authority to establish those programs and guidance and guidelines, and whether it's through regulation, gives the department staff with a level of expertise in the instruction area, the gifted area, for instance, really the ability to hone that information rather than trying to delineate every aspect in a statute.

[03:37:41] A statute is very difficult for you to define every bad, worst-case scenario and best-case scenario. It's a general applicability statute. So the teacher pipeline I don't see as an SOQ item. I see it first as an Appropriation Act item to get the funding.

[03:37:58] And then probably statutory amendments outside of the SOQ that may need to change things related to teacher licensure, education prep programs to that regard, but not an SOQ item. Thank you. Yeah. The, you know, the gifted program is already in the SOQ.

[03:38:17] That certainly is a proper place for it. You know, a floor of requirements that school divisions have to meet in trying to recognize the talent of every student, not just particular students. The background checks, that has not existed in the SOQ at all.

[03:38:36] And the statute is having its intent and meaning carried out. School divisions comply with that. And I don't think there's any objection to complying with that. I do not think any school division would ever want to hire someone that would place their children in jeopardy.

[03:38:53] So they're carrying that out. I don't think that's a necessity to put an ESOQ as a mandate in the ESOQ. School divisions are implementing that statute. But the gifted program definitely. Laboratory schools are in their own article in the code already.

[03:39:09] They are addressed. School construction is in the Appropriation Act with one small statute in the code. again not items for the SOQ and by it not being in the SOQ it also gives you greater flexibility in how it's carried out so right now some of the things that were talked about I think are excellent I things to pursue for student safety and and support for our teachers but they're not necessarily SOQ items I hope that gives you the explanation we need.

[03:39:44] Absolutely, thank you. Ms. McPherson, if you would like to unmute and make your comments. Can you hear me? Yes. Oh, great, great. All right, so I'm not with you in person today, but I have been online the entire time.

[03:40:02] I did want to thank staff for working on the revisions to the construction provisions. I have looked at them. I would like for us to carry them over to the next meeting because in the interim I do have some questions for staff regarding some of the recommendations so I can be in touch that way.

[03:40:22] Also, as it relates to the lab schools, I'm glad that we're going to have a presentation on that. I've been looking into that further. And I had one comment about the universal learners having standardized testing, and I understand the need for flexibility in different types of tests, But one of the things in the materials that's brought up is the fact that what we want to get away from is selective referrals by teachers and or principals or other administrators of students, which has a tendency to leave out some others that may be identified by testing.

[03:41:01] So I think we are looking for a system that will provide greater equality of identification while not necessarily overcomplicating the testing system and allowing for more flexibility, as Mr. Monk had indicated.

[03:41:20] So I just wanted to thank the staff for what they had done on construction, and I'll be present next month in person so that we can go into greater detail. Thanks. Thank you. Anything more on your presentation?

[03:41:38] No, I will go back and draft some language for the gifted program and the background checks. And I think, you know, we'll arrange for Amanda Nevetral to be here to present on the gifted program. Perfect. And also I will work on some more research on the pipeline, but I think that that's an exploration activity more so than something to prescribe at this point.

[03:42:05] and I will work on the letter to convey your desire for a funding model that is student-based to convey the will of the board. And if it, you know, once the superintendent gives me some direction on whether to convey information to the Department of Elections or other folks listed in the slide about your concerns on heightened standards for school board members.

[03:42:30] Perfect. Anything else for Ms. Velasquez? thank you so much we appreciate you thank you um so at this time we will go um into closed session for um legal advice the board's actually going to go into the other room so that we can eat lunch while we get our legal advice so um if i can have a motion i think dr northern would you read our

[03:43:03] motion to convene and close the session or not who has it it's right below you right there fine sorry it's in my pile of stuff i move that the virginia board of education convene in a closed meeting for the following purposes consultation with legal counsel and briefings by staff members or consultants pertaining to actual or probable litigation pursuant to section 2.2 371 a7 of the code of virginia consultation with legal counsel employed by or retained by a public body regarding

[03:43:43] specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice by such counsel pursuant to 2.2 three seven one one eight of the code of virginia and the legal counsel to virginia board of education and staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration of this matter would participate in the closed meeting dr. ackerman is there a second i'll second it dr. ackerman aye mr. green aye dr. northern aye um miss kilgore ah mr. monk aye and chair votes

[03:44:19] aye um if miss mcpherson can you still hear me yes okay can you um register your yes okay yes

[03:44:31] aye thank you um so the board is now in closed session thank you i would ask dr northern if she

[04:52:53] could read us back into open session please we convene today in a closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.23712 of the code of virginia that requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge one only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and two only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken place

[04:53:32] The statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes. Dr. Ackerman. Aye. Mr. Green. Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Mr. Monk. Aye. And chair votes aye. At this time, we are going to wrap up our meeting for the day, but the superintendent has a couple of comments that she would like to make.

[04:53:58] Thank you, President Creasy, members of the board. We had a few critical updates for the public, and since not everyone tunes into our work session, I may sound on repeat, but it's so important that everyone in the field hear these critical updates.

[04:54:16] So first, I want to again recognize Chief Conway and our entire early childhood care and education team for a wildly successful VQB5 rollout last week, including this new honor roll list. board had the opportunity yesterday if you missed it to see the map and really where excellence is happening is everywhere in all models that are serving our youngest learners and in every one of our regions across the commonwealth and as i noted yesterday i had the opportunity to represent

[04:54:51] the commonwealth of virginia with one of our house of delegates members mike cherry in atlanta to educate other states about Virginia's robust high-quality public-private marketplace that's grounded in parent demand and focused on really delivering the gold standard of excellence for our birth to five learners and we have multiple states that are interested in coming to learn how to do this the Virginia way it's had long bipartisan support they had a great early childhood Commission meeting yesterday and continuing the momentum around

[04:55:27] innovating and leading the way including on our up-and-coming digital wallet release to really help families have more access to affordable care and to give employers additional tools to support their employees in this pathway so once again if you haven't checked out the latest ratings on our portal join the other thousands of virginians who have checked that out in the last week we also wanted to provide an update as you heard from some of the public comments today on the accountability school performance and support framework rollout we are so thankful for our school divisions who

[04:56:06] have been making sure that we have all of the latest data from their divisions and in alignment with our data governance best practices the virginia department of education has been finalizing an agreement with a third party that is one of our public higher ed institutions to independently validate our accountability data and outcomes for every school and division to ensure transparency and our highest level of integrity once that is complete then all of our school division leaders will receive their division and individual school summary reports along with

[04:56:41] resources on how to communicate that with the public and we will then have that accountability data made public no less than one week after divisions have received that and had an opportunity review this will definitely not be the last time you hear about it before the board another item that has come up in the news so i want to make sure you hear it live here is around federal funding obviously a time of uncertainty and so i want to re-emphasize to those of you who are not able to tune in yesterday that currently our federal funds have been delivered as expected daily and there

[04:57:16] has been no disruption or cuts to the reimbursements for the virginia department of education and now this is true for several uh funding sources across our various federal agencies so that includes the u.s department of education health and human services department of labor and department of agriculture and not limited to that this continued support has allowed us at the agency to maintain our planned programs staffing and services for students without interruption and so we hope that our school board members our superintendents and others tuning in

[04:57:52] will relay that as needed to their constituents that we are in close communication with our federal contacts and will keep the virginia board and stakeholders informed of any necessary changes lastly i am still so proud of the board of education for taking a stance to expect more of our public school students here in the commonwealth since our last board meeting two more states have taken action to actually lower expectations for their students and

[04:58:26] virginia has been given a nod in the media for doing the opposite and really leading on our commitment that every student leave our public high schools ready for life whether it's in a career in military or service work or to succeed in college and we have had thousands of virginians who have joined us in listening sessions and written comments over the last three weeks looking forward to some additional sessions in the next two weeks before

[04:58:59] coming back to the board with our final proposal for implementation but really seeing great collaboration and partnership across the agency from various divisions and offices who are fielding questions helping to inform supports and new technical opportunities as we hear requests from educators parents and students to be set up for success and we just know that our students have demonstrated as have our teachers that every time we raise expectations they have delivered and we have the greatest confidence that they

[04:59:36] will do that again this time and with that President Creasy I turn back to you do any other board members have items for discussion of current issues that we have a section on our agenda before we adjourn today. Okay with that I will take a motion to adjourn. So moved. Second. And we are adjourned.

